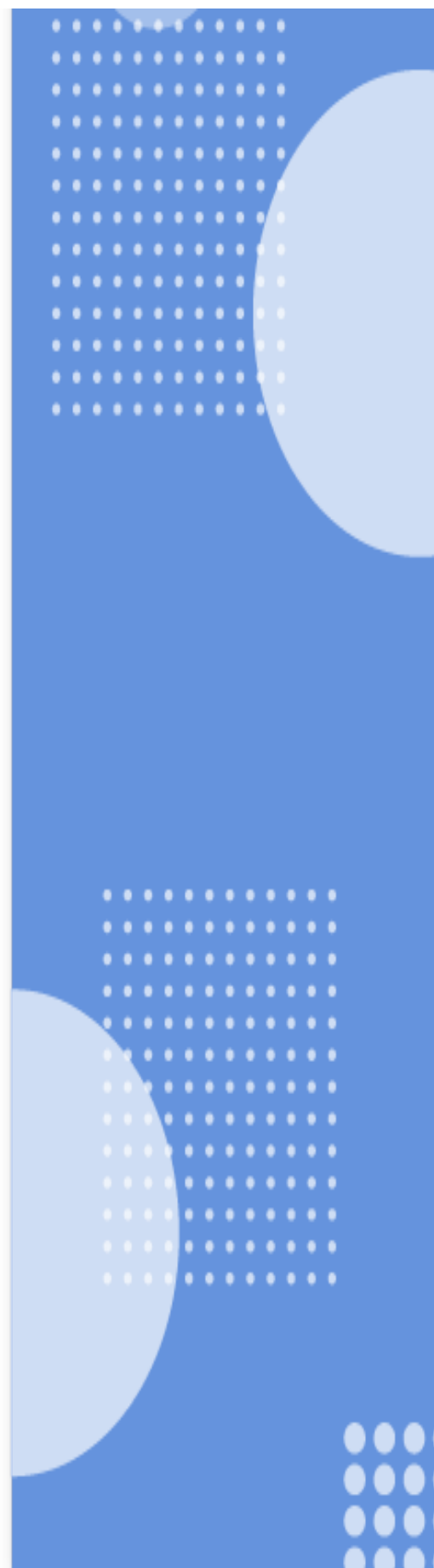


CONVERSATION STARTER

English Discussion Workbook Intermediate

- ❖ 50 short stories with audio files and comprehension questions
- ❖ 500 engaging discussion questions
- ❖ 500 topic related vocabulary and expressions
- ❖ 50 vocabulary worksheets
- ❖ Ideal for English language learners seeking to improve fluency and confidence
- ❖ Perfect for both individual learners and language teachers



INTRODUCTION

"Conversation Starter" is an English discussion workbook designed for ESL learners who want to improve their fluency and confidence in speaking English. This book is aimed at intermediate level learners and provides short stories with audio files, vocabulary and expressions, comprehension questions, discussion questions, and vocabulary worksheets.

This book features 50 short articles that cover a range of interesting and thought-provoking topics, from current events and culture to science and technology. Each article includes an audio file to help learners improve their listening skills, comprehension questions to test their understanding, 500 discussion questions to encourage learners to express their opinions and engage in meaningful conversations with their peers, and 500 vocabulary and expressions to expand their language proficiency.

In addition, the book also includes 50 vocabulary worksheets that focus on the key words and expressions used in each article. These worksheets provide an opportunity to practice and reinforce vocabulary knowledge, ensuring that learners retain what they've learned.

This book is designed for both teachers and learners. Teachers can use it as a resource for lesson planning or as a supplement to classroom materials, while learners can use it for self-study or in conversation groups.

Whether you are a teacher looking for a way to engage your students in conversation or a learner wanting to improve English language skills, "Conversation Starter" is an excellent resource that provides a variety of interesting and every-day topics to get the conversation flowing. So let's get started and start improving your English conversation skills today!

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UNIT 1: FAMILY AND RELATIONSHIPS

STORY 1: Family

STORY 2: Marriage

STORY 3: Parenting

STORY 4: Friendship

STORY 5: Love and dating

UNIT 1: FAMILY AND RELATIONSHIPS

Story 01: Family

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|-----------------|-----------------------------|
| 1. tight-knit | 6. daredevil |
| 2. catching up | 7. scraped knees |
| 3. role models | 8. successful |
| 4. passionate | 9. pursue |
| 5. construction | 10. have each other's backs |

My name is Henry, and I come from a loving and tight-knit family. I was born and raised in a small town, and I have two siblings: a younger brother and an older sister. Growing up, we spent a lot of time together as a family, whether it was playing board games, going on hikes, or just sitting around the dinner table and catching up on our day.

My parents have been married for over 30 years, and they have always been great role models for me and my siblings. They are hardworking, honest, and always put their family first. My mom is a teacher, and she has always been passionate about education and helping others. My dad works in construction and is incredibly skilled at building things with his hands.

My younger brother is a high school student, and he loves playing sports and spending time with his friends. He's always been a bit of a daredevil, which has led to a few scraped knees and broken bones over the years! My older sister is married and has two children, and she's an amazing mom. She's also a successful businesswoman and has inspired me to pursue my own goals and dreams.

Overall, I feel incredibly lucky to have such a wonderful family. We may not always agree on everything, but we always support each other and have each other's backs no matter what.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is the name of the person speaking in the passage?
2. How many siblings does Henry have?
3. What is Henry's mother's profession?
4. What does Henry's father do for a living?
5. How would you describe Henry's relationship with his family?

Conversations Starters:

1. How would you describe your family?
2. How often do you spend time with your family?
3. What are some of your favorite activities to do with your family?
4. Who is the most influential person in your family and why?
5. How have family roles and structures changed over the years in your country?
6. How important is it to have a close relationship with your siblings?
7. How has technology impacted the way families communicate with each other?
8. How often do you have family reunions or meet relatives?
9. Do you think it's better to have a big family or a small family?
10. What are some cultural differences in the way families are structured and function in your country compared to others?

UNIT 1: FAMILY AND RELATIONSHIPS

Story 02: Marriage

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|---------------------|-----------------|
| 1. Independent | 6. Balance |
| 2. Compromise | 7. Rewarding |
| 3. Social life | 8. Positive |
| 4. Merge | 9. Negative |
| 5. Learning process | 10. Significant |

Getting married was one of the biggest changes in my life. It was exciting and scary at the same time. On the positive side, I was happy to be with the person I loved and to have someone to share my life with. We had a beautiful wedding and a fantastic honeymoon, and I felt like I was on top of the world.

However, there were some challenging aspects as well. Living with someone else can be difficult, especially when you are used to being independent. We had to learn how to communicate effectively and compromise on things like household chores and finances. It was not always easy, but we were committed to making our marriage work.

One of the biggest changes was our social life. We had to balance spending time with each other and with our friends and family. We had to navigate different social circles and find a way to merge them. It was a learning process, but we eventually found a balance that worked for us.

Overall, getting married was a significant change in my life, both for the good and the bad. It was challenging at times, but it was also incredibly rewarding to share my life with someone I loved.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What were the positive aspects of getting married for the narrator?
2. What were some of the challenges of living with someone else?
3. How did the narrator and their partner handle socializing after getting married?
4. Was getting married a positive or negative change in the narrator's life?
5. Did the narrator feel prepared for the changes that came with getting married?

Conversations Starters:

1. What is your definition of marriage?
2. What do you think are the most important qualities to look for in a spouse?
3. How has your life changed since getting married?
4. What are some of the challenges you've faced in your marriage?
5. What are some of the benefits of being married?
6. What advice would you give to newlyweds?
7. What do you think are the most important factors for maintaining a happy marriage?
8. What should a person look for in his or her future spouse?
9. How do you think cultural differences impact marriage?
10. What is your opinion on arranged marriages?

UNIT 1: FAMILY AND RELATIONSHIPS

Story 03: Parenting

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|--------------------|------------------|
| 1. Perseverance | 6. Values |
| 2. Empathy | 7. Determination |
| 3. Self-sufficient | 8. Independent |
| 4. Comfort zone | 9. Supportive |
| 5. Prioritize | 10. Passion |

Raising successful children was one of the greatest joys of my life. It was also one of the biggest challenges. My partner and I worked hard to create a supportive and loving environment for our children to grow up in. We made sure to prioritize their education, and we encouraged them to pursue their passions.

One of the most important things we did was to lead by example. We showed our children the value of hard work, determination, and perseverance. We also taught them the importance of kindness, empathy, and respect for others.

We made sure to be present in their lives and to listen to their needs and concerns. We encouraged them to take risks and to pursue their dreams, even if it meant stepping outside of their comfort zone.

In the end, our children grew up to be successful in their own right. They pursued their passions and achieved great things, and we were proud to see them become independent and self-sufficient adults.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What were some of the values that the narrator and their partner prioritized in raising their children?
2. How did the narrator and their partner encourage their children to pursue their passions?
3. What was the role of leading by example in raising successful children?
4. What were some of the ways that the narrator and their partner were present in their children's lives?
5. How did the narrator feel about their children's success?

Conversation Starters:

1. What is your definition of good parenting?
2. What parenting style do you think is most effective?
3. What were some of the biggest challenges you faced as a parent?
4. How did you balance work and family life when raising your children?
5. What is your opinion on discipline and punishment in parenting?
6. How important do you think it is for parents to be involved in their children's education?
7. How can parents teach children about responsibility and independence?
8. How can parents instill values and morals in their children?
9. How has your parenting style evolved over time?
10. What advice would you give to someone who is about to become a parent?

UNIT 1: FAMILY AND RELATIONSHIPS

Story 04: Friendship

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. Engaged | 6. Mundane |
| 2. Biology | 7. Countless |
| 3. Evolved | 8. Celebrate |
| 4. Trust | 9. To be someone's rock |
| 5. Compassionate | 10. Hilarious |

I met my best friend in high school. We were both in the same biology class, and I remember noticing her because she was always so engaged in the material. After a few weeks of sitting next to each other and chatting about our shared interests, we realized that we had a lot in common.

Over the years, our friendship has grown and evolved. My best friend is someone who is always there for me, no matter what. She's been my rock through some of the toughest times in my life, and she's always been there to celebrate the good times too.

One of the things I love most about my best friend is her sense of humor. She has a way of making even the most mundane situations hilarious, and we've shared countless laughs over the years.

But more than that, she's someone who I know I can trust completely. She's honest, kind, and compassionate, and I feel so lucky to have her in my life.

Comprehension Questions:

1. How did the narrator meet their best friend?
2. What did the narrator and their best friend have in common?
3. What qualities does the narrator value in their best friend?
4. How has the narrator's friendship with their best friend evolved over time?
5. Why does the narrator feel lucky to have their best friend in their life?

Conversation Starters:

1. Please describe your best friend. What is he/she like? How did you meet?
2. What do you think is the most important quality in a friend, and why?
3. Can you maintain a friendship with someone who has different values than you? Why or why not?
4. How important is trust in a friendship? Can a friendship survive without it?
5. How do you handle conflict in a friendship? Is it better to confront the issue or avoid it?
6. Have you ever had a friendship end? What happened, and how did it affect you?
7. Do you think it's possible for men and women to be just friends, without any romantic feelings involved? Why or why not?
8. How do you make new friends as an adult? Is it easier or harder than making friends as a child?
9. How do you balance your friendships with other important relationships, like family or romantic partners?
10. Can social media enhance or damage friendships? How do you navigate social media in your friendships?

UNIT 1: FAMILY AND RELATIONSHIPS

Story 05: Love and dating

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|-------------------------|-----------------------|
| 1. Blind date | 6. Due diligence |
| 2. Hesitant | 7. Suitable match |
| 3. Benefit of the doubt | 8. Proceeded to |
| 4. Red flag | 9. Obvious discomfort |
| 5. Ex-girlfriends | 10. Disappointed |

I had been single for a while and my friends thought it was time for me to start dating again. They set me up on a blind date with a guy they swore was perfect for me. I was hesitant at first, but eventually agreed to go.

The date started off well enough. We went to a nice restaurant and had a good conversation. But then things took a turn. He started talking about all of his ex-girlfriends and how they had all been crazy. I found this to be a huge red flag, but tried to give him the benefit of the doubt.

Then, as we were walking to our cars, he asked if he could come back to my place. I was shocked and told him no. He then proceeded to try to kiss me, despite my obvious discomfort.

I ended the date there and went home feeling disappointed and uncomfortable. It was clear that my friends had not done their due diligence in finding me a suitable match.

Comprehension Questions:

1. How did the narrator feel about going on the blind date at first?
2. Where did the blind date take place?
3. What did the guy talk about during the date that made the narrator uncomfortable?
4. What did the guy ask to do after the date?
5. How did the narrator feel after the date was over?

Conversations Starters:

1. Have you ever had a really good date? What made it memorable?
2. Have you ever had a bad date? What happened and how did you handle it?
3. What is your opinion on dating apps? Do you think they are a good way to find a suitable match or do they promote superficial judgments?
4. Have you ever been on a blind date? How did it go? Would you be willing to try it again?
5. What are some important factors to consider when going on a first date? How do you prepare for a first date?
6. How do you think dating has changed over the years? Do you think it has become easier or harder to find love and maintain relationships?
7. How important is communication in a romantic relationship? How do you make sure you and your partner are on the same page?
8. Do you think it's important to have common interests with your partner? Why or why not?
9. How do you deal with rejection in the dating world? Do you have any advice for someone who may be struggling with this?
10. Do you believe in love at first sight? Why or why not? Have you ever experienced it?

UNIT 2: HOME AND NEIGHBORHOOD

STORY 1: Homes

STORY 2: Neighborhoods

STORY 3: Museums

STORY 4: Parks

STORY 5: Cafes and restaurants

UNIT 2: HOME AND NEIGHBORHOOD

Story 01: Homes

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|------------------|-------------------|
| 1. Spacious | 6. Canopy bed |
| 2. Fond memories | 7. Hues |
| 3. Hide and seek | 8. Messiest |
| 4. Unique | 9. Bean bag chair |
| 5. Built-in | 10. Soak |

My home is a spacious two-story house with four bedrooms and three bathrooms. It has always been my favorite place to be, and I have many fond memories of growing up there. When I was a kid, my siblings and I used to play hide and seek, and we always found new spots to hide. My parents loved to entertain, and we often had family gatherings in our large dining room.

The bedrooms are all on the second floor, and each one has its own unique style. My parents' room is large and cozy with a king-sized bed and a big window overlooking the backyard. My room is painted light blue, my favorite color, and it has a built-in bookshelf that I used to fill with all of my favorite books. My younger sister's room is decorated with pink and purple hues, and she has a canopy bed that she loves to read in. My older brother's room has always been the messiest, but it's also the most comfortable, with a large bean bag chair and a TV.

The three bathrooms make it easy for everyone to get ready in the morning, and there's never any fighting over who gets to use the shower first. The biggest bathroom has a large bathtub that I love to soak in after a long day.

I still live in my childhood home, and it's still the place where I feel the most comfortable and relaxed. It's a special place that holds so many memories and I can't imagine ever leaving it.

Comprehension Questions:

1. How many bedrooms does the home have?
2. Where are the bedrooms located in the house?
3. What did the speaker and their siblings used to play in the house?
4. What is unique about each of the bedrooms?
5. Why does the speaker love their home?

Conversations Starters:

1. Could you describe your current home?
2. What are some important factors that you consider when choosing a home? Location, size, amenities, etc.?
3. Have you ever lived in a different country? How did the homes there compare to those in your home country?
4. What was your childhood home like? What are some fond memories you have of that home?
5. Do you prefer living in a house or an apartment? Why?
6. Have you ever renovated or made changes to your home? What did you do and why?
7. Have you ever experienced a natural disaster or other event that affected your home? How did you deal with it?
8. What are some ways that you try to make your home environmentally friendly?
9. How important is it to have a sense of community in your neighborhood? Do you know your neighbors?
10. Do you think owning a home is important for financial stability? Why or why not?

UNIT 2: HOME AND NEIGHBORHOOD

Story 02: Neighborhoods

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|--------------|-------------------------|
| 1. Bustling | 6. Center of the action |
| 2. Chatter | 7. Tranquility |
| 3. Enriching | 8. Skyline |
| 4. Galleries | 9. Chaos |
| 5. Broadway | 10. Balcony |

I live in the heart of Manhattan, in a bustling neighborhood full of life and energy. Every day, I am surrounded by the sounds of honking horns, the chatter of people rushing to their next destination, and the clinking of glasses at the local cafes and bars.

One of my favorite things about my neighborhood is the diversity. People from all over the world come to live and work here, and it makes for a truly unique and interesting community. I've made friends with people from all different cultures and backgrounds, and it's been an enriching experience.

There are plenty of things to do in my neighborhood, from visiting the museums and galleries, to catching a show on Broadway, or simply walking around and exploring the different shops and restaurants. It's never boring, and I always feel like I'm in the center of the action.

But amidst all the hustle and bustle, there are also peaceful moments. I love taking a walk in Central Park on a quiet morning, or sitting on my balcony and watching the sun set over the city skyline. It's a reminder that even in the midst of chaos, there is always beauty and tranquility to be found.

Comprehension Questions:

1. Where does the speaker live?
2. What are some of the sounds the speaker hears in their neighborhood?
3. What does the speaker like about their neighborhood?
4. What are some activities the speaker enjoys doing in their neighborhood?
5. What are some peaceful moments the speaker enjoys in their neighborhood?

Conversations Starters:

1. Describe your neighborhood. What do you like or dislike about it?
2. What do you think makes a neighborhood a good place to live?
3. What are some of your favorite memories from your childhood neighborhood?
4. Have you ever lived in a bad neighborhood? What were some of the challenges you faced?
5. What are some important factors that you consider when choosing a new neighborhood to move to?
6. Have you ever experienced any issues with noise or disturbances in your neighborhood? How did you handle it?
7. How do you think neighborhoods affect a person's sense of community and belonging?
8. What are some ways that you try to be a good neighbor to those around you?
9. Do you think it's important for a neighborhood to have access to public transportation? Why or why not?
10. Do you think it's important for neighborhoods to have parks or green spaces? Why or why not?

UNIT 2: HOME AND NEIGHBORHOOD

Story 03: Museums

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| 1. Vast | 6. DNA |
| 2. Exhibits | 7. Iconic |
| 3. Evolution | 8. Pivotal |
| 4. Ancestors | 9. Feats |
| 5. Mind-blowing | 10. Engineering |

I recently had the chance to visit the Smithsonian Museum in Washington D.C., and it was an incredible experience. The museum is so vast and full of fascinating exhibits that it's impossible to see everything in just one visit.

I started my tour in the Hall of Human Origins, where I learned about the evolution of humans and our ancestors. It was mind-blowing to see the physical evidence of how humans have evolved over time and how we are all connected through our DNA.

Next, I headed to the National Museum of American History, where I saw iconic artifacts such as the original Star-Spangled Banner and the First Ladies' Inaugural Gowns. I also learned about some of the pivotal moments in American history, such as the Civil Rights Movement and the Apollo 11 moon landing.

Finally, I ended my visit at the National Air and Space Museum, where I saw historic airplanes and spacecraft, including the Wright Brothers' plane and the Apollo 11 Command Module. It was amazing to see these objects up close and to imagine the incredible feats of engineering that made flight and space travel possible.

Overall, visiting the Smithsonian Museum was an unforgettable experience that deepened my understanding of the world around me and the history that has shaped it.

Comprehension Questions:

1. Where is the Smithsonian Museum located?
2. What is the Hall of Human Origins about?
3. What are some iconic artifacts at the National Museum of American History?
4. What are some pivotal moments in American history?
5. What did the speaker see at the National Air and Space Museum?

Conversations Starters:

1. Do you enjoy visiting museums? Why or why not?
2. What is your favorite type of museum to visit? Art, history, science, etc.?
3. Have you visited any museums in your neighborhood or city? Which ones and what did you think of them?
4. How important do you think museums are in preserving history and culture?
5. Have you ever been to a museum that was underwhelming or disappointing? What happened?
6. What are some ways that museums can make exhibits more interactive and engaging for visitors?
7. Do you think museums should be free to the public or should there be an admission fee? Why?
8. How do museums contribute to education and learning? Can you give any specific examples?
9. Have you ever been to a museum that made a lasting impression on you? What was it and why was it memorable?
10. Do you think museums will continue to be important in the future, or will technology replace the need for physical exhibits?

UNIT 2: HOME AND NEIGHBORHOOD

Story 04: Parks

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|-----------------|-----------------------|
| 1. Unwind | 6. Expending |
| 2. Benches | 7. Picnic |
| 3. Surroundings | 8. Serene |
| 4. Nieces | 9. Tranquility |
| 5. Nephews | 10. Hustle and bustle |

I live near a park that has become one of my favorite places to go to unwind and relax. It's a beautiful park with lots of trees, benches, and a small lake in the middle. When I go there, I like to take a walk around the lake and enjoy the peacefulness of the surroundings.

There's also a playground in the park, which is great for when I bring my young nieces and nephews to play. They love the swings and slides, and I enjoy watching them have fun and expending their energy.

Another thing I like to do at the park is have a picnic with friends. We bring blankets and baskets of food and enjoy the sunshine and fresh air while catching up and enjoying each other's company.

One of my favorite memories at the park was when I saw a group of people practicing tai chi by the lake. It was such a serene and beautiful sight to see, and it inspired me to try it out for myself.

Overall, this park near my home has become a special place for me, where I can escape the hustle and bustle of city life and find a bit of peace and tranquility.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is the park near the narrator's home like?
2. What does the narrator like to do at the park with his young nieces and nephews?
3. What does the narrator like to do at the park with his friends?
4. What inspired the narrator to try tai chi?
5. What does the park near the narrator's home mean to him?

Conversations Starters:

1. What is your favorite park in your neighborhood or city? Why?
2. What is your favorite activity to do at a park?
3. What are some common activities people do at parks in your country?
4. Have you ever visited a park in another country? What was it like?
5. How important do you think parks are for a community?
6. Do you think parks should be free to the public or should there be an admission fee? Why?
7. Have you ever had a memorable experience at a park? What happened?
8. What are some things that can be done to make parks more accessible and enjoyable for everyone?
9. What is your opinion on parks that allow dogs? Should they be allowed or not? Why?
10. Do you think parks are important for mental and physical health? Why or why not?

UNIT 2: HOME AND NEIGHBORHOOD

Story 05: Cafes and restaurants

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|---------------------|-----------------------------|
| 1. Cozy | 6. Poached egg |
| 2. Stumbled upon | 7. Flavorful |
| 3. Inviting | 8. Regulars |
| 4. Delicious treats | 9. Strike up a conversation |
| 5. Gourmet | 10. Rejuvenated |

My favorite cafe is a cozy little spot in the heart of the city. I stumbled upon it one day while I was out exploring, and I've been a regular ever since. From the moment I walked in, I was greeted with warm smiles and friendly hellos. The atmosphere was inviting, with soft lighting and comfortable seating that made me feel right at home.

The menu is full of delicious treats, from freshly baked pastries to gourmet sandwiches and salads. My personal favorite is the avocado toast with a poached egg on top - it's the perfect combination of creamy and savory. And of course, the coffee is always excellent - smooth, rich, and flavorful.

What I love most about this cafe, though, is the community. The staff and regulars are like family, always eager to strike up a conversation or share a laugh. I've met some of my closest friends here, and I always leave feeling refreshed and rejuvenated.

Comprehension Questions:

1. How did this person discover the cafe?
2. What was the atmosphere like inside the cafe?
3. What is the person's favorite item on the menu?
4. How does this person feel about the community at the cafe?
5. How does this person feel after leaving the cafe?

Conversations Starters:

1. What are some of your favorite cafes or restaurants in your city or town?
2. What do you look for in a good cafe or restaurant?
3. Do you prefer cozy, intimate cafes or bustling, trendy restaurants?
4. What is the most memorable dining experience you've ever had?
5. Have you ever had a negative experience at a restaurant or cafe? What happened?
6. Do you prefer trying new restaurants or going to your favorite spots?
7. Have you ever worked in a restaurant or cafe? What was your experience like?
8. What is the most unique or unusual restaurant or cafe you've ever been to?
9. Do you prefer to dine alone or with friends/family? Why?
10. How important is the ambiance and decor of a restaurant or cafe to you?

UNIT 3: ENTERTAINMENT

STORY 1: Movies and TV shows

STORY 2: Books

STORY 3: Music

STORY 4: Video, Mobile, PC Games

STORY 5: Childhood games

UNIT 3: Entertainment

Story 01: Movies and TV shows

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|-------------------------|------------------------|
| 1. Fast-paced | 6. Escape from reality |
| 2. Thrilling | 7. Special effects |
| 3. Stunts | 8. Choreography |
| 4. Come out on top | 9. Cinematography |
| 5. Impossible situation | 10. Sequences |

I have always been a fan of action movies, ever since I was a kid. There's just something about the fast-paced action and thrilling stunts that really gets my heart racing. I love the way the hero always manages to come out on top, no matter how impossible the situation seems.

I think part of the reason I enjoy action movies so much is that they allow me to escape from reality for a little while. When I'm watching an action movie, I can forget about my own problems and worries and lose myself in the excitement of the story. It's like taking a mini-vacation from my own life.

Of course, I also appreciate the artistry that goes into making a good action movie. The special effects, choreography, and cinematography are all top-notch, and it's always fun to see how they bring the action sequences to life on screen.

All in all, there's just something about action movies that really speaks to me. They're thrilling, exciting, and a great way to unwind after a long day.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is the narrator's opinion of action movies?
2. Why does the narrator enjoy action movies?
3. How do action movies help the narrator escape from reality?
4. What does the narrator appreciate about the artistry of action movies?
5. What words would the narrator use to describe action movies?

Conversations Starters:

1. What are some of your favorite movies or TV shows, and why do you enjoy them?
2. Do you prefer watching movies or TV shows? Why?
3. How do you usually decide what to watch?
4. What is the most memorable movie or TV show you've ever seen?
5. Have you ever binge-watched a TV show? What was it, and what was your experience like?
6. Do you like watching movies or TV shows in their original language, or do you prefer dubbed or subtitled versions?
7. Have you ever been disappointed by a movie or TV show that you were really excited to watch? What happened?
8. Do you think movies and TV shows have the power to influence society or change people's attitudes? Give an example.
9. What do you think of the current state of the movie and TV industry? Are there any trends or changes you would like to see?
10. Do you have any favorite actors or actresses, and why do you admire them?

UNIT 3: ENTERTAINMENT

Story 02: Books

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|---------------|------------------|
| 1. Weaves | 6. Resistance |
| 2. Narrative | 7. Occupation |
| 3. Masterful | 8. Admiration |
| 4. Sacrifices | 9. Resilience |
| 5. Bravery | 10. Stay with me |

One of the best books I've ever read was "The Nightingale" by Kristin Hannah. From the first page, I was drawn into the story of two sisters living in France during World War II. The way Hannah weaves history, love, and family into the narrative is simply masterful. I laughed, cried, and felt every emotion alongside the characters.

What I loved most about this book was how it gave voice to the women of the war - their struggles, sacrifices, and bravery. I was inspired by the courage of the sisters, who risked everything to resist the Nazi occupation and protect their loved ones.

As I turned the final page, I felt a sense of loss, as if I was saying goodbye to dear friends. But at the same time, I was left with a feeling of hope and admiration for the resilience of the human spirit. "The Nightingale" is a book that will stay with me for a long time.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is the title of the book that the protagonist is discussing?
2. What is the book about?
3. How does the author incorporate history into the narrative?
4. What is the protagonist's opinion of the book?
5. How does the book make the protagonist feel?

Conversations Starters:

1. What are some of your favorite books or genres, and why do you enjoy them?
2. Have you ever read a book that changed your perspective or had a significant impact on your life? What was it, and why was it important to you?
3. How do you usually decide what books to read?
4. Do you prefer reading physical books or e-books? Why?
5. How do you think technology has affected the way we read and consume books?
6. Have you ever read a book in a language that is not your first language? What was it, and how did you find the experience?
7. What is the most recent book you've read, and what did you think of it?
8. How do you think reading books compares to watching movies or TV shows? Do you prefer one over the other?
9. What do you think of the current state of the publishing industry? Are there any trends or changes you would like to see?
10. Do you have any favorite authors or literary characters, and why do you admire them?

UNIT 3: ENTERTAINMENT

Story 03: Music

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

1. Die-hard
2. Bubblegum pop
3. Catchy hooks
4. Upbeat melodies
5. Raw energy
6. Musicianship
7. Artistry
8. Intricate guitar solos
9. Soaring vocal melodies
10. Speak to my soul

Hi, I'm Brian, and I used to be a die-hard pop music fan. I loved everything from bubblegum pop to boy bands, and I couldn't get enough of catchy hooks and upbeat melodies. But something changed a few years ago when I discovered the world of rock music.

It all started when a friend introduced me to a band called Foo Fighters. I had heard of them before but had never really given them a chance. But as soon as I heard the opening riff of "Everlong," I was hooked. From there, I dove headfirst into the world of rock music - from classic bands like Led Zeppelin and Pink Floyd to modern groups like Royal Blood and The Black Keys.

What I love about rock music is the raw energy and emotion that it conveys. There's something about the sound of a distorted guitar or pounding drums that just gets my blood pumping. I also appreciate the musicianship and artistry that goes into creating a great rock song - the intricate guitar solos, the soaring vocal melodies, and the powerful lyrics.

Nowadays, you'll find me listening to rock music more often than pop. I still appreciate a good pop song now and then, but there's something about rock music that speaks to my soul.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What was Brian's music preference before discovering rock music?
2. How did Brian discover rock music?
3. What does Brian appreciate about rock music?
4. How has Brian's music listening habits changed since discovering rock music?
5. What words would Brian use to describe rock music?

Conversations Starters:

1. What type of music do you enjoy listening to, and why?
2. Have you ever attended a concert? If so, who did you see and what was the experience like?
3. How do you usually discover new music?
4. Do you prefer listening to music alone or with other people? Why?
5. How has technology affected the way we listen to and consume music?
6. Have you ever played a musical instrument? If so, which one(s) and how did you learn?
7. Do you think music has the power to influence people's emotions and behaviors? How?
8. What is your opinion of the current state of the music industry? Are there any trends or changes you would like to see?
9. Who are some of your favorite musicians or bands, and why do you admire them?
10. Have you ever attended a music festival? What was it like, and would you go again?

UNIT 3: ENTERTAINMENT

Story 04: Video, Mobile, PC Games

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|----------------------|--------------|
| 1. Trash-talking | 6. Elation |
| 2. Fast-paced action | 7. Memories |
| 3. Strategy | 8. Cherish |
| 4. Outmaneuvering | 9. Grown up |
| 5. Bragging rights | 10. Moved on |

When I was in middle school, one of my favorite pastimes was playing video games with my friends. We would spend hours on end glued to the TV, playing our favorite games and trash-talking each other as we went.

My favorite game back then was Super Smash Bros. - a classic fighting game featuring Nintendo characters like Mario, Link, and Donkey Kong. I loved the fast-paced action and the strategy involved in outmaneuvering my opponents.

But what made the game even better was playing it with my friends. We would set up tournaments and compete against each other, with the winner earning bragging rights until the next time we played. I still remember the feeling of elation I felt when I pulled off a particularly tricky move or knocked out all of my opponents to come out on top.

Looking back, those were some of the best times of my life. Even though I've since grown up and moved on from video games, I'll always cherish the memories of playing Super Smash Bros. with my middle school friends.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What was the protagonist's favorite video game in middle school?
2. Who did the protagonist play video games with?
3. What did the protagonist enjoy about playing Super Smash Bros.?
4. How did the protagonist feel when they won a game?
5. Does the protagonist still play video games now?

Conversations Starters:

1. What type of video games do you enjoy playing, and why?
2. How do you usually choose which games to play?
3. What is your favorite video game of all time, and why?
4. Have you ever played mobile games? If so, what are some of your favorites?
5. What are some benefits and drawbacks of playing video games?
6. Do you think video games can be addictive? Why or why not?
7. How has technology affected the video game industry in recent years?
8. What are some of the most popular PC games right now, and what makes them appealing to players?
9. Have you ever played online multiplayer games? What was your experience like?
10. What do you think the future of gaming will look like?

UNIT 3: ENTERTAINMENT

Story 05: Childhood games

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|------------------|----------------|
| 1. Hide and seek | 6. Creative |
| 2. Tag | 7. Giggling |
| 3. Kickball | 8. Flashlights |
| 4. Hiding spots | 9. Navigate |
| 5. Seeker | 10. Nostalgia |

When I was a kid, one of my favorite things to do with my friends was play games. We would spend hours outside, running around and laughing as we played games like hide and seek, tag, and kickball.

Hide and seek was always one of our favorites. We would find creative hiding spots and try to stay hidden for as long as possible, giggling silently as the seeker searched for us. Sometimes we would play at night, using flashlights to navigate the dark and make the game even more exciting.

Tag was another game we loved. We would chase each other around, trying to be the one to tag someone else and become "it." The game was especially fun when we played it at the park or on the playground, using the equipment to climb and hide and make the game more challenging.

Looking back, those childhood games were some of the happiest times of my life. Even though I'm older now and don't play those games as much, I still look back on those memories with fondness and nostalgia.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What were some of the childhood games the protagonist played?
2. Which game was the protagonist's favorite?
3. What did the protagonist and their friends do when they played hide and seek at night?
4. Where did the protagonist and their friends play tag?
5. How does the protagonist feel about their memories of playing childhood games?

Conversations Starters:

1. What were some of your favorite games to play as a child?
2. Did you have any special rules or variations for the games you played?
3. Did you usually play games with friends or by yourself?
4. Were there any games you didn't like to play? Why?
5. Did you have a favorite place to play games?
6. Were you ever part of a sports team or club when you were a child?
7. How did playing games as a child influence your life today?
8. Do you think kids today still play the same games you played as a child? Why or why not?
9. How do you think technology has affected the way children play games today?
10. If you could go back in time and play one childhood game again, which one would it be and why?

UNIT 4: HEALTH AND WELLNESS

STORY 1: Exercising

STORY 2: Nutrition

STORY 3: Dealing with stress

STORY 4: Hospitals and Illnesses

STORY 5: Home remedies and treatments

UNIT 4: HEALTH AND WELLNESS

Story 01: Exercising

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|-------------------------|-----------------|
| 1. Endorphins | 6. Kickboxing |
| 2. Sedentary lifestyle | 7. Fresh |
| 3. Cardio | 8. Routine |
| 4. Strength training | 9. Motivate |
| 5. Bodyweight exercises | 10. In the zone |

I work out 5 times a week because it makes me feel good. It's not just about getting in shape or losing weight (although those are nice side effects), it's about the rush of endorphins and the sense of accomplishment that comes from pushing myself to be better.

I didn't always love working out. In fact, I used to hate it. But then I started seeing the results - my clothes fit better, I had more energy, and I felt happier overall. Now I can't imagine going back to a sedentary lifestyle.

I mix up my workouts to keep things interesting. Sometimes I'll do cardio, like running or biking, and other times I'll focus on strength training with weights or bodyweight exercises. I also like to take classes, like yoga or kickboxing, to keep things fresh.

Working out has become a part of my daily routine, and I look forward to it every day. It's not always easy to motivate myself to get started, but once I'm in the zone, there's no stopping me.

Comprehension Questions:

1. Why does the protagonist work out 5 times a week?
2. What are some benefits the protagonist has seen from working out?
3. Did the protagonist always enjoy working out? Why or why not?
4. How does the protagonist keep their workouts interesting?
5. How does the protagonist feel about working out now?

Conversations Starters:

1. What kind of exercise do you enjoy doing the most?
2. Why do you think exercise is important for overall health?
3. Have you ever struggled with motivation to exercise? What did you do to overcome it?
4. How has exercise impacted your mental health?
5. Do you prefer exercising alone or with a partner/group? Why?
6. Have you ever tried a new type of exercise that you didn't like? What was it and why didn't you enjoy it?
7. How often do you think people should exercise to maintain a healthy lifestyle?
8. Have you ever had an injury from exercise? What happened and how did you recover?
9. How do you think technology has impacted the way people exercise?
10. What kind of exercise or physical activity is trending or popular these days?

UNIT 4: HEALTH AND WELLNESS

Story 02: Nutrition

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|------------------|----------------------|
| 1. Vicious cycle | 6. Overwhelming |
| 2. Eating habits | 7. Sluggish |
| 3. Guilty | 8. Fitting |
| 4. Ashamed | 9. Protagonist |
| 5. Swapping out | 10. Physical effects |

I know that I should be eating healthier, I just can't seem to stop eating junk food. It's become a vicious cycle - I feel bad about my eating habits, so I eat more junk food to make myself feel better, but then I feel worse about my health.

It's not just about the physical effects, either. I know that eating unhealthy foods is affecting my mental health, too. I feel guilty and ashamed every time I reach for another bag of chips or candy bar, but I just can't seem to stop.

I've tried making small changes, like swapping out junk food for healthier options, but it never lasts. I always end up falling back into old habits. I know I need to make a change, but it feels overwhelming.

I'm starting to notice the effects on my body, too. I'm more tired and sluggish than usual, and my clothes aren't fitting the way they used to. I know I need to make a change before it's too late.

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Comprehension Questions:

1. Why does the protagonist struggle with eating junk food?
2. How has eating unhealthy foods affected the protagonist's mental health?
3. What steps has the protagonist taken to improve their eating habits?
4. Why does the protagonist keep falling back into old habits?
5. What physical effects has the protagonist noticed from eating junk food?

Conversations Starters:

1. What does a healthy diet mean to you?
2. Why do you think it's important to eat a balanced diet?
3. What kind of junk food do you enjoy eating the most?
4. How does eating junk food make you feel?
5. What steps do you take to maintain a healthy diet?
6. Do you think it's difficult to eat healthily? Why or why not?
7. What are some healthy snacks that you enjoy?
8. What are some cultural foods that are healthy but not commonly known outside of your country?
9. What are some common misconceptions about nutrition that you have heard?
10. Have you ever tried a diet or eating plan that did not work for you? What was it and why didn't it work?

UNIT 4: HEALTH AND WELLNESS

Story 03: Dealing with stress

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|----------------------|----------------------|
| 1. Coping mechanisms | 6. Self-care |
| 2. Overwhelmed | 7. Mental break |
| 3. Drowning | 8. Desk job |
| 4. Therapeutic | 9. Support system |
| 5. Prioritize | 10. Cope with stress |

My job can be extremely stressful at times. There are days where it feels like the work just keeps piling up, and I can't seem to get a break. It's easy to get overwhelmed and start feeling like I'm drowning.

To deal with this stress, I've developed a few coping mechanisms. First and foremost, I make sure to take breaks throughout the day. Whether it's taking a quick walk around the block or just stepping away from my desk for a few minutes, it's important to give myself a mental break.

I also find that exercise helps me manage stress. Whether it's going for a run or taking a yoga class, getting my body moving and focusing on something else for a while can be incredibly therapeutic.

Lastly, I make sure to talk about my stress with someone I trust. Whether it's a friend, family member, or therapist, having someone to listen and offer support can make all the difference.

It's not always easy to manage stress, but I've found that these techniques have helped me tremendously. It's important to prioritize self-care and take the time to manage stress in a healthy way.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is the protagonist's job like?
2. How does the protagonist feel when they experience stress?
3. What are some coping mechanisms that the protagonist uses to manage stress?
4. How does exercise help the protagonist manage stress?
5. Why is it important for the protagonist to talk about their stress with someone they trust?

Conversations Starters:

1. What are some common causes of stress?
2. How do you personally deal with stress?
3. What are some healthy ways to manage stress?
4. Why is it important to take breaks throughout the day to manage stress?
5. How can exercise help manage stress?
6. How do different cultures deal with stress?
7. What are some unhealthy coping mechanisms that people use to deal with stress?
8. How can mindfulness and meditation help manage stress?
9. Have you ever experienced burnout from stress? How did you handle it?
10. What are some ways that employers can help their employees manage stress in the workplace?

UNIT 4: HEALTH AND WELLNESS

Story 04: Hospitals and illnesses

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|--------------------------|-----------------|
| 1. Ached | 6. Medical help |
| 2. Respiratory infection | 7. Care |
| 3. Antibiotics | 8. Serious |
| 4. Fluids | 9. Ignore |
| 5. Grateful | 10. Signs |

I remember the time I got really sick and had to go to the hospital. I had been feeling off for a few days, but I didn't think much of it. Then, one morning, I woke up feeling absolutely terrible. My whole body ached, and I was having trouble breathing.

I knew I needed to go to the hospital, but I was scared. I didn't want to be there by myself, so I called a friend to come with me. It was a good thing I did, because I ended up staying in the hospital for several days.

The doctors ran all sorts of tests and eventually determined that I had a serious respiratory infection. They gave me some strong antibiotics and fluids, and I started to feel better slowly. It was a tough few days, but I was grateful for the care I received at the hospital.

Since then, I've learned to pay closer attention to my body and not ignore any signs that something might be wrong. It's important to take care of ourselves and seek medical help when we need it.

Comprehension Questions:

1. How did the protagonist feel before going to the hospital?
2. Why was the protagonist scared to go to the hospital?
3. How long did the protagonist stay in the hospital?
4. What did the doctors determine was wrong with the protagonist?
5. What did the protagonist learn from the experience?

Conversations Starters:

1. Have you ever been to a hospital before? What was your experience like?
2. What are some common illnesses that people go to the hospital for?
3. How can hospitals be improved to make patients more comfortable?
4. Do you think it's important for hospitals to have interpreters for patients who don't speak the same language as the medical staff?
5. What are some things people can do to prevent getting sick?
6. How do different cultures view the role of hospitals and medical care?
7. Have you ever had a positive or negative experience with medical staff? What happened?
8. Do you think healthcare should be free?
9. How do you think hospitals have been impacted by the COVID-19 pandemic?
10. What advice would you give to someone who is afraid of going to the hospital?

UNIT 4: HEALTH AND WELLNESS

Story 05: Home remedies and treatments

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|--------------|--------------------------------|
| 1. Miserable | 6. Ritual |
| 2. Soothed | 7. Comforting |
| 3. Nutrition | 8. Symptom |
| 4. Sinuses | 9. Germs |
| 5. Infection | 10. Coming down with something |

I remember the first time I got really sick. I was only six years old, and it was the flu. I was miserable; I had a fever, a sore throat, and a headache. My mom took care of me, and she made me chicken noodle soup. I didn't feel like eating anything, but when she brought me the soup, the smell was so good that I couldn't resist it.

As soon as I took a sip, I felt better. The warm broth soothed my throat, and the vegetables and chicken gave me some much-needed nutrition. From that day on, whenever I got sick, my mom would make me chicken noodle soup, and it always made me feel better.

As I got older, I learned that there was actually some science behind why chicken noodle soup is good for you when you have a cold or the flu. The warm broth helps to clear your sinuses, and the vegetables and chicken provide your body with nutrients to help fight the infection.

Now, whenever I feel like I'm coming down with something, I make myself a big pot of chicken noodle soup. It's become a comforting ritual for me, and I always feel like I'm taking good care of myself when I eat it.

Comprehension Questions:

1. How old was the narrator when they first got sick?
2. What symptoms did the narrator have when they were sick?
3. Who took care of the narrator when they were sick?
4. What effect did the chicken noodle soup have on the narrator?
5. Why does the narrator still eat chicken noodle soup when they feel sick?

Conversations Starters:

1. Do you believe in using home remedies to treat common ailments like colds and headaches? Why or why not?
2. What are some of the most effective home remedies you have used or heard of?
3. How do you decide whether to use home remedies or to seek medical advice from a doctor or healthcare professional?
4. Do you think traditional or alternative medicine can be as effective as modern medicine? Why or why not?
5. Have you ever had a negative experience with modern medicine, such as side effects or misdiagnosis? What happened?
6. Do you think there are any risks associated with using home remedies, such as allergic reactions or ineffective treatments? How can these risks be minimized?
7. In your opinion, what role should doctors and healthcare professionals play in helping patients decide between home remedies and modern medicine?
8. Have you ever tried a home remedy that was recommended to you by someone else, but it didn't work for you? What did you do instead?
9. Do you think home remedies can be more cost-effective than modern medicine? Why or why not?
10. How can people balance the benefits of using home remedies with the need for evidence-based treatments and professional medical advice?

UNIT 5: WORK AND CAREER

STORY 1: Popular jobs and careers

STORY 2: Workplace culture and colleagues

STORY 3: Interesting and dangerous jobs

STORY 4: Leadership in the workplace

STORY 5: Common problems in the workplace

UNIT 5: WORK AND CAREER

Story 01: Popular jobs and careers

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|---------------|-------------------------|
| 1. Monotonous | 6. Technical skills |
| 2. Impact | 7. Significant |
| 3. Industry | 8. Tight deadlines |
| 4. Evolving | 9. Meaningful solutions |
| 5. Creativity | 10. High-quality work |

As a software engineer, I have always been fascinated by the power of code. Being able to create something out of nothing, solve complex problems, and make people's lives easier is truly rewarding. However, there are also aspects of my job that I don't particularly enjoy.

One thing that I love about my job is the challenge of it. Every project is different, and it requires me to use different tools and technologies. I enjoy learning new things and using that knowledge to solve problems. It's also a job that requires constant learning and keeping up with the latest trends in the industry.

On the other hand, there are times when I feel frustrated with my job. Sometimes the work can be monotonous, and I feel like I'm just writing lines of code without making a significant impact. It can also be stressful when deadlines are tight, and there's a lot of pressure to deliver high-quality work.

Despite the challenges, I know that I'm in a field that is always evolving, and I'm proud to be a part of it. Being a software engineer allows me to use my creativity and technical skills to create meaningful solutions.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is the main character's profession?
2. What does the main character enjoy about their job?
3. Does the main character like every aspect of their job?
4. What frustrates the main character about their job?
5. Why is the main character proud to be a software engineer?

Conversation Starters:

1. What factors do you consider when choosing a job or career?
2. What are some popular jobs in your country? Why do you think they are popular?
3. What are some in-demand jobs in your field or industry?
4. What has been your personal experience with job interviews?
5. What do you think are the most important skills to have in order to be successful in your chosen profession?
6. Do you think people should pursue careers solely based on salary and benefits? Why or why not?
7. What do you think are the pros and cons of working remotely?
8. Have you ever had a job that you didn't enjoy? What did you do about it?
9. If you could have any job or a career, what would it be?
10. What advice would you give to someone who is just starting out in their career?

UNIT 5: WORK AND CAREER

Story 02: Workplace culture and colleagues

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|----------------------|------------------|
| 1. Work-life balance | 6. Development |
| 2. Well-being | 7. Collaboration |
| 3. Perks | 8. Empowered |
| 4. Flexibility | 9. Innovative |
| 5. Personal growth | 10. Solutions |

As a software engineer working at Google, I've been fortunate enough to experience a work culture that's unlike any other. From the moment I walked through the doors on my first day, I knew that I was part of a team that valued collaboration, creativity, and innovation.

One thing that stands out about Google's work culture is the emphasis on work-life balance. The company offers a range of benefits and perks that promote employee well-being, such as free meals, on-site fitness centers, and flexible work hours. This allows me to focus on my work without worrying about burning out.

Another aspect of Google's work culture that I appreciate is the focus on personal growth and development. The company encourages employees to take risks and pursue new challenges, which has allowed me to grow both professionally and personally.

But perhaps the most significant aspect of Google's work culture is the collaborative spirit. Teamwork is encouraged, and employees are always willing to lend a helping hand. This creates a supportive environment where everyone's ideas are valued and respected.

Overall, I feel fortunate to work for a company with such a positive and innovative work culture. It's a place where I feel empowered to grow, learn, and create meaningful solutions.

Comprehension Questions:

1. Where does the narrator work?
2. What are some values that the narrator's company promotes?
3. How does the narrator feel about the work-life balance at the company?
4. What does the company encourage its employees to do?
5. What is the most significant aspect of the company's work culture, according to the narrator?

Conversations Starters:

1. How would you define a positive workplace culture?
2. What are some qualities that you appreciate in your colleagues?
3. What do you think distinguishes a good boss from a bad boss?
4. Have you ever worked for a boss that you didn't get along with? How did you handle the situation?
5. What is your opinion on workplace friendships?
6. What do you think is the most important factor in maintaining a positive work environment?
7. Have you ever experienced workplace bullying or harassment? How did you handle the situation?
8. How do you handle conflicts with coworkers or superiors in the workplace?
9. What is your opinion on diversity and inclusivity in the workplace?
10. What advice would you give to someone who is experiencing workplace stress or burnout?

UNIT 5: WORK AND CAREER

Story 03: Interesting and dangerous jobs

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. Unpredictable | 6. Icy temperatures |
| 2. Harsh weather | 7. Contend |
| 3. Braving | 8. Crew members |
| 4. High winds | 9. Camaraderie |
| 5. Rough waves | 10. Thrill of the catch |

As a king crab fisherman, I spend most of my time out at sea, braving the harsh weather and unpredictable waters of the Bering Sea. It's a dangerous job, but one that can also be very rewarding.

Every day on the boat is a battle against the elements. High winds, rough waves, and icy temperatures are just some of the challenges we face. But we also have to contend with the dangers of working with heavy equipment, such as crab pots, and the risk of falling overboard.

Despite the risks, being a king crab fisherman has its benefits. It's a job that offers good pay and the satisfaction of a hard day's work. We also get to work alongside a tight-knit group of crew members, and the camaraderie on the boat is second to none.

But perhaps the greatest reward of all is the thrill of the catch. When we bring up a pot full of king crab, it's a rush of excitement and accomplishment. It's what keeps us going back out to sea, year after year.

Overall, being a king crab fisherman is a tough but fulfilling job. It's not for everyone, but for those of us who love the thrill of the catch and the challenge of the sea, there's nothing else like it.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is the main character's job?
2. What are some of the dangers of being a king crab fisherman?
3. What are some of the benefits of the job?
4. What does the main character find most rewarding about the job?
5. Is being a king crab fisherman a job for everyone?

Conversations Starters:

1. What do you think are some of the most dangerous jobs in the world?
2. Have you ever had an interesting job? What made it interesting?
3. Do you think people should pursue careers that are considered dangerous? Why or why not?
4. What is the most physically demanding job you can think of?
5. Have you ever had a job that required you to work with dangerous equipment? What precautions did you take to ensure your safety?
6. Do you think it's important for people to have a job that they find interesting and fulfilling? Why or why not?
7. What are some jobs that require a lot of mental focus and concentration? How do you think people manage to stay focused for long periods of time?
8. Have you ever worked in a job where you felt like you were making a difference in the world? What was the job, and how did it make you feel?
9. What is your opinion on jobs that require people to work long hours or unconventional schedules?
10. How do you think society should approach the issue of dangerous jobs, especially those that are essential to the functioning of society?

UNIT 5: WORK AND CAREER

Story 04: Leadership in the workplace

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|------------------|--------------------|
| 1. Competent | 6. Concerns |
| 2. Compassionate | 7. Motivate |
| 3. Admire | 8. Recognition |
| 4. Communicator | 9. Concise |
| 5. Feedback | 10. Rally together |

I'm lucky enough to work for a leader who inspires me every day. His name is John, and he's one of the most competent and compassionate leaders I've ever had the pleasure of working with.

John possesses many admirable traits that make him an excellent leader. For one, he's an excellent communicator, always making sure to keep his team informed about the latest developments and goals. He's also an excellent listener, taking the time to hear his team's feedback and concerns.

One of John's greatest strengths as a leader is his ability to inspire and motivate his team. He's always quick to offer words of encouragement and recognition for a job well done. His leadership style creates a positive work environment where everyone feels valued and appreciated.

An example of John's leadership ability that comes to mind was during a time when our team was facing a difficult deadline. Despite the stress and pressure of the situation, John remained calm and focused, guiding us through the project with clear and concise direction. He was able to rally the team together, and we were able to complete the project on time and with high quality.

Overall, John is an exceptional leader who embodies all the traits that make a great leader. I feel incredibly lucky to work under his guidance.

Comprehension Questions:

1. Who is the leader the main character works with?
2. What are some of the traits that the leader possesses?
3. How does the leader communicate with his team?
4. What is the leader's strength in motivating his team?
5. Can you give an example of the leader's ability to lead under pressure?

Conversations Starters:

1. What qualities do you think make a good leader in the workplace?
2. Have you ever worked for a boss that you felt was a poor leader? What were some of the issues you encountered?
3. How do you think leadership and management differ? Are they the same thing?
4. What do you think is the most important role of a leader in the workplace?
5. Do you think leaders should prioritize the needs of their team over the needs of the company? Why or why not?
6. What are some examples of leadership skills that you possess? How do you think these skills can benefit you in the workplace?
7. Have you ever been in a leadership role? What did you learn from the experience?
8. How do you think leaders can effectively communicate with their team members?
9. Do you think it's important for leaders to admit when they're wrong or make a mistake? Why or why not?
10. What advice would you give to someone who is aspiring to become a leader in their workplace?

UNIT 5: WORK AND CAREER

Story 05: Common Problems in the workplace

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|--------------------|------------------|
| 1. Complaints | 6. Detrimental |
| 2. Conflicts | 7. Comes up |
| 3. Interrupting | 8. Disengagement |
| 4. Job description | 9. Concerns |
| 5. Burnout | 10. Addressing |

As an HR manager, I hear a lot of complaints and concerns from employees. One common problem that comes up is conflicts with coworkers. For example, I once had an employee come to me with concerns about a coworker who was constantly interrupting them during meetings and not letting them finish their thoughts. This was causing a lot of frustration and making it difficult for the employee to do their job effectively.

Another common complaint is about workloads and feeling overwhelmed. Employees may feel like they have too much on their plate or are being given tasks that are outside their job description. This can lead to stress and burnout, which can be detrimental to their health and wellbeing.

Another issue that comes up frequently is poor communication. Employees may feel like they're not getting enough information about changes in the company or that their opinions and feedback aren't being heard. This can lead to feelings of disconnect and disengagement from the company.

Overall, as an HR manager, I try to listen carefully to these concerns and work with employees and management to find solutions that work for everyone. By addressing these common problems and complaints, we can create a better work environment for everyone.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is one common problem that employees have at work?
2. Can you give an example of a conflict between coworkers?
3. How do workloads and feeling overwhelmed affect employee health?
4. What is the impact of poor communication in the workplace?
5. How does addressing common problems and complaints help to create a better work environment?

Conversations Starters:

1. What are some common complaints that employees have about their workplaces?
2. Have you ever experienced any of these common complaints in your workplace? How did you handle the situation?
3. Do you think it's important for employers to address complaints and problems in the workplace? Why or why not?
4. What are some of the consequences of not addressing complaints and problems in the workplace?
5. How do you think employers can foster a positive work environment that minimizes complaints and problems?
6. What are some strategies for dealing with conflict between coworkers?
7. How do you think employees can effectively communicate their concerns to their employers?
8. Have you ever felt overwhelmed by your workload? What did you do to manage the situation?
9. What are some ways that employers can support their employees' mental and emotional health?
10. What advice would you give to someone who is experiencing problems or complaints in their workplace?

UNIT 6: SOCIAL MEDIA AND THE INTERNET

STORY 1: E-commerce

STORY 2: Social media

STORY 3: Cyberbullying

STORY 4: Fake news

STORY 5: Streaming services

UNIT 6: SOCIAL MEDIA AND THE INTERNET

Story 01: E-commerce

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|--------------------|------------------------|
| 1. Avid | 6. Competitive pricing |
| 2. Ecommerce | 7. Convenience |
| 3. Unbeatable | 8. Selection |
| 4. Outweighs | 9. Downsides |
| 5. Return policies | 10. Benefits |

As an avid online shopper, I always turn to ecommerce sites like Amazon.com for my purchases. The convenience and selection of products available is unbeatable. With ecommerce, I can easily browse a wide selection of products, read reviews from other customers, and compare prices all from the comfort of my own home.

One of the downsides to e-commerce is that I can't physically touch or try on the products before purchasing them. However, the convenience of shopping online often outweighs this disadvantage. Plus, many ecommerce sites have generous return policies in case the item doesn't meet my expectations.

My most recent purchase on Amazon was a new book by my favorite author. The book was priced very competitively, and with Amazon's free two-day shipping, I received it quickly and was able to start reading right away.

Overall, I continue to be a loyal ecommerce shopper because of the convenience and selection of products available. While there are some potential downsides, I find that the benefits outweigh the risks.

Comprehension Questions:

1. Why does the main character prefer ecommerce sites like Amazon?
2. What are some advantages of shopping online?
3. What are some disadvantages of shopping online?
4. What was the most recent item the main character purchased on Amazon?
5. How does the main character feel about ecommerce shopping overall?

Conversations Starters:

1. What are some advantages of online shopping?
2. What are some disadvantages of online shopping?
3. How do you feel about shopping online versus shopping in person?
4. What kind of products do you prefer to buy online?
5. What are some concerns you have about shopping online?
6. Have you ever had a negative experience with online shopping? What happened?
7. Do you think the convenience of online shopping is worth the potential risks?
8. How do you decide whether to buy a product online or in a physical store?
9. What are some ways that ecommerce companies can improve the online shopping experience for customers?
10. Do you think ecommerce is the future of shopping? Why or why not?

UNIT 6: SOCIAL MEDIA AND THE INTERNET

Story 02: Social media

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|--------------------|--------------------------|
| 1. Millennial | 6. Positive way |
| 2. Followers | 7. Influencers |
| 3. Visual platform | 8. Creative |
| 4. Cyberbullying | 9. Unique |
| 5. Mindful | 10. Mental health impact |

As a millennial, I am quite familiar with social media and I use it on a daily basis. My favorite social media site is Instagram. I love being able to share photos and videos with my friends and followers, and I enjoy seeing the content that others post as well.

One of the things I appreciate about Instagram is that it is a very visual platform, which allows me to express myself in creative and unique ways. I also love being able to follow my favorite celebrities, artists, and other influencers to see what they are up to.

However, I do recognize that there are some potential downsides to social media, such as the risk of cyberbullying and the negative impact it can have on mental health. That's why I try to use social media in a mindful and positive way, and I make sure to take breaks from it when necessary.

Overall, I find that Instagram is a great way to connect with others and share my life with the world.

Comprehension Questions:

1. How often does the main character use social media?
2. What is the main character's favorite social media site?
3. Why does the main character appreciate Instagram?
4. What are some potential downsides of social media?
5. How does the main character try to use social media in a positive way?

Conversations Starters:

1. How often do you use social media?
2. What is your favorite social media site and why?
3. What are some positive aspects of social media?
4. What are some negative aspects of social media?
5. How do you manage your social media use to ensure that it doesn't negatively impact your mental health?
6. How has social media changed the way we communicate with others?
7. How do you think social media will continue to evolve in the future?
8. What is your opinion on children wanting to become an influencer?
9. How can we use social media in a positive way to connect with others and promote social change?
10. What advice would you give to someone who is struggling with social media addiction or negative effects of social media on their mental health?

UNIT 6: SOCIAL MEDIA AND THE INTERNET

Story 03: Cyberbullying

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|------------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. Prevalent | 6. Assemblies |
| 2. Insidious | 7. Workshops |
| 3. Code of conduct | 8. Collaborative effort |
| 4. Guidance counselors | 9. Address |
| 5. Administrators | 10. Trusted adult |

As a high school teacher, one of the most concerning issues I see with my students is cyberbullying. With the rise of social media and online communication, bullying has become even more prevalent and insidious.

Our school takes cyberbullying very seriously and has implemented several measures to prevent it. We have a strict code of conduct that students are required to follow, and any instances of cyberbullying are immediately addressed by our guidance counselors and administrators. We also hold regular assemblies and workshops to educate students on the dangers of cyberbullying and how to prevent it.

However, prevention isn't just the responsibility of the school. Parents can also play a crucial role in preventing cyberbullying. They can monitor their children's online activity and have open and honest conversations with them about the importance of treating others with respect and kindness online. Parents can also encourage their children to report any instances of cyberbullying to a trusted adult.

Overall, cyberbullying is a serious issue that requires a collaborative effort from both schools and parents to prevent and address.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is cyberbullying?
2. Why is cyberbullying so concerning for high school teachers?
3. What measures has the school implemented to prevent cyberbullying?
4. What role can parents play in preventing cyberbullying?
5. Why is it important for students to report instances of cyberbullying to a trusted adult?

Conversations Starters:

1. Have you ever witnessed bullying? What happened?
2. What are some different types of bullying?
3. How has the rise of technology and social media impacted bullying?
4. What are some potential long-term effects of bullying?
5. How can we effectively prevent bullying?
6. What is cyberbullying, and how is it different from traditional bullying?
7. How can we prevent cyberbullying?
8. How can we support victims of bullying and help them feel safe and empowered?
9. Do you think schools are doing enough to address bullying? Why or why not?
10. What can individuals do to stand up against bullying in their communities?

UNIT 6: SOCIAL MEDIA AND THE INTERNET

Story 04: Fake news

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|----------------------------|----------------------------|
| 1. Misinformation | 6. Exploited workers |
| 2. Confusion | 7. Legitimate news sources |
| 3. Real-world consequences | 8. Public opinion |
| 4. Evidence | 9. Combat |
| 5. National security | 10. Accurately informed |

As a journalist, I've seen firsthand the damaging effects of fake news on our society. Not only does it spread misinformation and confusion, but it can also have real-world consequences.

One example of fake news that I encountered was a story that claimed a certain politician had ties to a foreign government and was actively working to undermine national security. The story was shared widely on social media and even picked up by some news outlets, despite the fact that there was no evidence to support the claim.

Another example of fake news I came across was a story that claimed a certain brand of clothing was made using child labor and exploited workers. The story was shared widely on social media, leading many people to boycott the brand, even though it was later proven to be false.

Fake news can have serious consequences, from eroding trust in legitimate news sources to influencing public opinion and even causing harm. As journalists, it's our duty to verify information and report only the facts, in order to combat the spread of fake news and ensure that the public is informed accurately.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is fake news?
2. What are some of the damaging effects of fake news?
3. Can you give an example of fake news related to a politician?
4. Can you give an example of fake news related to a brand?
5. What is the responsibility of journalists in combating fake news?

Conversations Starters:

1. What is your definition of fake news?
2. How does fake news impact society?
3. What are some ways to combat fake news?
4. Do you think social media companies have a responsibility to combat fake news? Why or why not?
5. What are some ethical concerns surrounding the spread of fake news?
6. Do you think censorship is ever justified when it comes to news and information?
7. How do you determine if a news source is reliable or trustworthy?
8. What role do you think journalists play in combating fake news?
9. How has the rise of the internet and social media impacted the spread of fake news?
10. Have you ever encountered fake news? How did you react?

UNIT 6: SOCIAL MEDIA AND THE INTERNET

Story 05: Streaming services

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|-------------------|----------------------|
| 1. Enthusiast | 6. Advantages |
| 2. Indulge | 7. Downsides |
| 3. Binge-watch | 8. Addiction |
| 4. Go-to | 9. Subscription fees |
| 5. Unique content | 10. Revolutionized |

As a Netflix enthusiast, I love to indulge in my favorite show whenever I have some free time. I typically watch a few episodes each week, but if I'm really invested in a series, I might binge-watch several episodes in one sitting. I find it convenient to be able to watch my favorite shows whenever and wherever I want, whether it's on my laptop, phone, or TV.

While Netflix is my go-to streaming service, I also use other platforms like Hulu and Amazon Prime Video. Each service has its own unique content and features, and I appreciate being able to switch between them depending on what I'm in the mood for.

One of the biggest advantages of streaming services is the sheer amount of content that's available at your fingertips. From classic movies to new releases to original series, there's something for everyone. However, there are also some downsides, such as the potential for addiction and the cost of subscription fees.

Overall, I believe that streaming services have revolutionized the way we consume media, and I'm excited to see where the future of entertainment will take us.

Comprehension Questions:

1. How often does the speaker watch my favorite show on Netflix?
2. Does the speaker use other streaming sites besides Netflix?
3. What are the benefits of streaming services?
4. What are some downsides of streaming services?
5. What is the speaker's overall opinion of streaming services?

Conversations Starters:

1. What are your favorite TV shows or movies to watch on streaming services?
2. What streaming services do you currently use?
3. Do you think that streaming services have had a positive or negative impact on the entertainment industry?
4. What are some pros and cons of binge-watching TV shows?
5. Do you prefer to watch TV shows as they are released or wait until the entire season is available to stream?
6. What are some popular TV shows that you think are overrated?
7. Have you ever discovered a new TV show or movie through a streaming service that you wouldn't have watched otherwise?
8. What is your opinion on the rising cost of subscription fees for streaming services?
9. Do you think that streaming services are taking over traditional TV channels? Why or why not?
10. How has the availability of streaming services changed the way you consume media?

UNIT 7: SPORTS

STORY 1: Popular sports

STORY 2: Team sports vs Individual sports

STORY 3: Olympics

STORY 4: Youth sports

STORY 5: Extreme sports

UNIT 7: SPORTS

Story 01: Popular sports

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|------------------|----------------|
| 1. Appreciate | 6. Excitement |
| 2. Evident | 7. Global |
| 3. Accessibility | 8. Attract |
| 4. Passionate | 9. Qualities |
| 5. Energy | 10. Individual |

Growing up, I was always interested in sports, both playing and watching them. Over the years, I've come to appreciate a variety of sports, but I believe that soccer is the most popular sport in the world. This is evident in the fact that it is played and watched by millions of people worldwide.

One of the reasons for soccer's popularity is its simplicity. All you need is a ball and some space to play, which makes it accessible to people of all ages and backgrounds. Additionally, it can be played with just a few people or as part of a larger team, and it's a great way to stay active and healthy.

Personally, I enjoy playing soccer with friends, but I also love watching professional matches on TV. The energy and excitement of a stadium full of passionate fans is truly amazing to witness.

Despite its global popularity, soccer is just one of many sports that people love and enjoy around the world. Each sport has its own unique qualities and attracts different types of fans. Ultimately, it's up to each individual to decide which sports they enjoy the most.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is the most popular sport in the world according to the author?
2. What makes soccer accessible to people of all ages and backgrounds?
3. What does the author enjoy about watching professional soccer matches?
4. What are some other popular sports besides soccer?
5. Who gets to decide which sports are enjoyable?

Conversations Starters:

1. What is your favorite sport to play? Why?
2. Do you prefer watching sports or playing them? Why?
3. What is the most popular sport in your country? Why do you think it's so popular?
4. Are there any sports that you find boring to watch? Why?
5. Have you ever attended a live sporting event? What was it like?
6. Do you have a favorite sports team or athlete? Why do you like them?
7. What do you think about sports as a form of entertainment? Are they more than just a game?
8. Have you ever tried playing a sport that you didn't enjoy watching on TV? Did your opinion change?
9. Do you think that sports can bring people from different cultures and backgrounds together?
10. What do you think is the most important aspect of sports: winning or participation? Why?

UNIT 7: SPORTS

Story 02: Team sports vs Individual sports

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|---|----------------------|
| 1. Calmness | 6. Championship |
| 2. Focus | 7. Accountability |
| 3. Chaos | 8. Success |
| 4. Green (referring to the golf course) | 9. Failure |
| 5. Hole-in-one | 10. Mental fortitude |

Golf has been my favorite sport since I was a kid. I love the calmness and focus that come with playing alone, away from the chaos of team sports. Whenever I'm on the green, I forget about everything else and just enjoy the moment. The sound of the club hitting the ball and the feel of a perfect shot are unmatched in any other sport.

My favorite golf memory was during a tournament where I hit a hole-in-one on the final hole to win the championship. I remember the excitement and relief I felt as I watched the ball roll into the hole, and the crowd cheering me on. It was a moment I'll never forget.

The main difference between team sports and individual sports is the level of responsibility. In team sports, you're accountable not only for your performance but also for your teammates' performance. In individual sports, you're solely responsible for your own success or failure. However, the similarities lie in the focus and determination required to succeed. Whether in a team or individual sport, you need to have the mental fortitude to stay focused and perform under pressure.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is the author's favorite sport?
2. What does the author like about playing golf?
3. What was the author's favorite golf memory?
4. What is the main difference between team sports and individual sports?
5. What is required to succeed in both team and individual sports?

Conversations Starters:

1. What makes golf different from other individual sports?
2. Have you ever played golf? What did you think of it?
3. Do you prefer team sports or individual sports? Why?
4. What are the benefits of playing an individual sport?
5. In what ways does playing a team sport differ from playing an individual sport?
6. Have you ever played a team sport or an individual sport? Which did you prefer and why?
7. What is your favorite memory of playing a sport, either individually or as part of a team?
8. How does playing a sport help you develop important life skills?
9. What do you think are the key differences between playing golf for fun and playing golf competitively?
10. What role do mental toughness and focus play in individual sports like golf?

UNIT 7: SPORTS

Story 03: Olympics

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|---------------------------|---------------------|
| 1. Grace | 6. Hard work |
| 2. Flawless | 7. Mental toughness |
| 3. All-around competition | 8. Resilience |
| 4. Unparalleled skills | 9. Overcome |
| 5. Dedication | 10. Courage |

My favorite Olympic game is gymnastics. I've always been fascinated by the incredible physical abilities and grace of the gymnasts. The sport requires an immense amount of strength, flexibility, and focus, making it both challenging and rewarding.

One of my most memorable Olympic games was watching Simone Biles win the gold medal in the all-around competition in Rio de Janeiro. Her flawless execution and unparalleled skills left the crowd in awe, and I was on the edge of my seat the entire time. It was truly an inspiring moment, and it reminded me of the dedication and hard work that goes into becoming an Olympic athlete.

Gymnastics is not just about performing amazing feats of strength and agility. It also requires mental toughness and resilience. The gymnasts must be able to overcome their fears and doubts to perform at their best, and that takes a lot of courage.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is the author's favorite Olympic game?
2. What qualities does the sport of gymnastics require?
3. What was the author's most memorable Olympic moment?
4. Why does the author find gymnastics inspiring?
5. What is required in addition to physical ability to be a successful gymnast?

Conversations Starters:

1. What are the benefits of hosting the Olympics in a city or country?
2. What makes gymnastics different from other Olympic sports?
3. Have you ever tried gymnastics? What did you think of it?
4. What are some of the challenges that Olympic athletes face?
5. In your opinion, which Olympic event requires the most skill?
6. What are some of the important qualities that an Olympic athlete should possess?
7. Do you think that the Olympics should have age restrictions for certain events?
8. What is your favorite Olympic moment, and why did it inspire you?
9. How do you think Olympic athletes handle the pressure and scrutiny of the competition?
10. What can we learn from Olympic athletes, both in terms of sports and life in general?

UNIT 7: SPORTS

Story 04: Youth sports

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|----------------|--------------------|
| 1. Camaraderie | 6. Championship |
| 2. Teamwork | 7. Pride |
| 3. Challenge | 8. Dedication |
| 4. Improvement | 9. Persistence |
| 5. Competition | 10. Supportiveness |

I have always loved playing Little League baseball. It was the highlight of my week during the spring and summer months. I enjoyed the feeling of camaraderie and teamwork that came with being part of a team. I also loved the challenge of improving my skills and competing against other teams.

One of my fondest memories was hitting a home run in a championship game when I was 12 years old. The excitement and pride I felt were indescribable. It was a moment I'll never forget, and it reminded me of the hard work and dedication I had put into the sport.

Playing Little League baseball taught me many important life lessons. I learned the value of hard work, persistence, and determination. I also learned how to be a good teammate and support my fellow players, even when things weren't going well. These skills have stayed with me throughout my life and have helped me in many areas, not just in sports.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is the author's favorite childhood sport?
2. What did the author enjoy about playing Little League baseball?
3. What was the author's favorite memory of playing baseball?
4. What did playing youth sports teach the author?
5. How have the skills learned through playing Little League baseball helped the author in their life?

Conversations Starters:

1. What sports did you play when you were growing up?
2. Do you think it's important for children to participate in sports? Why or why not?
3. What are the benefits of playing team sports for children?
4. Have you ever had a particularly memorable moment while playing youth sports?
5. In what ways can participating in youth sports help children develop important life skills?
6. What is the role of parents and coaches in youth sports?
7. What are some of the challenges that children face when playing sports?
8. How do sports promote physical and mental well-being in children?
9. What are the differences between playing team sports and individual sports as a child?
10. In your opinion, what is the most important thing children can learn from playing sports?

UNIT 7: SPORTS

Story 05: Extreme sports

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| 1. Rush of adrenaline | 6. Set of dangers |
| 2. Pushing yourself to the limit | 7. Take necessary precautions |
| 3. Base jumping | 8. Follow protocols |
| 4. Achieving the impossible | 9. Perseverance |
| 5. Capable of more than we think | 10. Facing one's fears |

I have always loved extreme sports. There's something about the rush of adrenaline and the feeling of being alive that comes with pushing yourself to the limit that is hard to beat. My favorite extreme sport is base jumping. The feeling of leaping off a tall structure and soaring through the air is a feeling unlike any other.

People often ask me why I take such risks. For me, it's about pushing past my fears and limitations and experiencing life in a different way. There's no better feeling than achieving something you once thought was impossible. It's a reminder that we are capable of so much more than we think.

Of course, extreme sports come with their own set of dangers and risks. Safety is always a top priority, and I make sure to take all necessary precautions and follow all protocols. It's important to respect the risks and not take unnecessary chances.

Extreme sports have taught me many important life lessons, such as the value of perseverance, determination, and facing one's fears. They have also allowed me to explore and experience the world in a way that few others get to.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is the author's favorite extreme sport?
2. Why does the author enjoy extreme sports?
3. What is the author's approach to safety in extreme sports?
4. What has the author learned from participating in extreme sports?
5. What are some of the dangers associated with extreme sports?

Conversations Starters:

1. What is your opinion of extreme sports?
2. Have you ever participated in an extreme sport? If so, which one?
3. What draws people to extreme sports?
4. What are the dangers associated with extreme sports?
5. Should extreme sports be more regulated to ensure the safety of participants?
6. Are extreme sports more appealing to younger people? Why or why not?
7. In your opinion, what is the most dangerous extreme sport?
8. What can we learn from those who participate in extreme sports?
9. Do you think extreme sports are worth the risk? Why or why not?
10. How do extreme sports compare to other types of sports in terms of skill, athleticism, and risk?

UNIT 8: MONEY AND FINANCE

STORY 1: Investing

STORY 2: Passive income

STORY 3: Budgeting and spending

STORY 4: Retirement

STORY 5: Winning the lottery

UNIT 8: MONEY AND FINANCE

Story 01: Investing

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|--------------------------|-----------------|
| 1. Diversification | 6. Adjusting |
| 2. Portfolio | 7. Nest egg |
| 3. Mutual funds | 8. Golden years |
| 4. 401(k) | 9. Emotions |
| 5. Economic developments | 10. Panic |

I have always been interested in investing my money. When I first started out, I made some mistakes that cost me dearly. One of my biggest mistakes was putting all my savings into a single stock that I thought was going to take off. Unfortunately, the stock didn't perform as well as I thought it would, and I lost a lot of money.

After that experience, I realized the importance of diversification in investing. I started to invest in a mix of stocks, bonds, and mutual funds. I also began to regularly contribute to my 401(k) retirement account. My current investment strategy involves monitoring the market trends, staying informed about economic developments, and adjusting my portfolio accordingly.

My main investment goal is to build a sizable nest egg that will allow me to retire comfortably and enjoy my golden years. I believe that investing in a diverse portfolio is the best way to achieve this goal.

One of the most valuable lessons I've learned is to not let my emotions drive my investment decisions. When the market takes a dip, it's easy to panic and sell off investments, but I've learned to stay the course and trust in the long-term growth of my portfolio.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What was one of the narrator's biggest investment mistakes when he first started out?
2. How did the narrator's investment strategy change after his mistake?
3. What types of investments does the narrator currently hold in his portfolio?
4. What is the narrator's main investment goal?
5. What is one of the most valuable lessons the narrator has learned about investing?

Conversations Starters:

1. What do you think are some common mistakes people make when investing their money?
2. Have you ever made an investment mistake? If so, what was it and what did you learn from it?
3. How do you determine what your investment goals should be?
4. What is your main investment goal, and how do you plan to achieve it?
5. Do you prefer investing in low-risk or high-risk assets, and why?
6. How do you stay informed about economic developments and market trends when investing?
7. What role do emotions play in your investment decisions?
8. How important is diversification in investing, and how do you ensure that your portfolio is diverse?
9. What advice would you give to someone who is just starting to invest their money?
10. Do you think it's ever too late to start investing? Why or why not?

UNIT 8: MONEY AND FINANCE

Story 02: Passive income

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|-----------------------|-------------------------|
| 1. Financial freedom | 6. Analysis |
| 2. Passive income | 7. Landlord |
| 3. Resignation letter | 8. Legal aspects |
| 4. Corporation | 9. Pursuing hobbies |
| 5. Rental properties | 10. Traditional 9-5 job |

I am thrilled to share my story with you. My name is Jane and I retired at the age of 40. It was an incredible achievement, and I still remember the day I turned in my resignation letter to my boss. I had worked for a large corporation for over a decade, and I was ready for a change. But how did I achieve financial freedom so early in life? It was all thanks to passive income.

I created a passive income stream by investing in rental properties. At first, it was difficult to find the right properties to invest in. I had to do a lot of research and analysis to determine which properties would generate the most income. I also had to learn how to manage tenants, deal with repairs and maintenance, and understand the legal aspects of being a landlord. However, once I had a few properties up and running, the income started to flow in.

These days, my life is amazing. I spend my days traveling, volunteering, and pursuing my hobbies. I have the freedom to do what I want when I want. My passive income allows me to live comfortably without having to work a traditional 9-5 job.

Comprehension Questions:

1. At what age did Jane retire?
2. How did Jane create passive income?
3. What challenges did Jane face when investing in rental properties?
4. What does Jane do with her time now that she's retired?
5. How does passive income allow Jane to live?

Conversations Starters:

1. What does financial freedom mean to you? Is it a priority in your life?
2. What are some examples of passive income streams that you know of? Which ones do you think are the most effective?
3. Do you think early retirement is achievable for most people? What steps would someone need to take to retire early?
4. How do you balance saving for retirement and enjoying life in the present?
5. Have you ever invested in rental properties or any other form of passive income? If so, what was your experience like?
6. What are some potential risks and challenges of relying solely on passive income?
7. What factors should someone consider before deciding to retire early?
8. Do you think the concept of retirement will look different in the future? How so?
9. What role do personal values and goals play in achieving financial freedom and early retirement?
10. What advice would you give to someone who is interested in pursuing passive income or early retirement?

UNIT 8: MONEY AND FINANCE

Story 03: Budgeting and spending

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|----------------------|--------------------|
| 1. Budgeting | 6. Spreadsheet |
| 2. Tracking spending | 7. Potluck dinners |
| 3. Revelations | 8. Subscriptions |
| 4. Dining out | 9. Memberships |
| 5. Recurring fees | 10. Goal |

I've been trying to save up money to buy a bigger house for a while now. In order to do that, I knew I had to make some changes to my spending habits. I started budgeting and tracking my spending to see where my money was going. And boy, was I surprised!

One of the biggest revelations was how much money I was spending on eating out. I knew I enjoyed dining out with friends and family, but I didn't realize just how much money I was spending on it. Once I added up all the meals, coffees, and snacks, I was shocked. I was easily spending hundreds of dollars a month on eating out.

Another surprise was how much I was spending on subscriptions and memberships. I had signed up for various services over the years, and many of them had recurring fees. I didn't even realize how much money I was spending on them until I saw the total amount in my budget spreadsheet.

After seeing these spending habits, I decided to make some changes. I started cooking at home more often and inviting friends over for potluck dinners. I also canceled some of my subscriptions and memberships that I wasn't using regularly. These small changes have helped me save a lot of money, and I'm now much closer to my goal of buying a bigger house.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is the narrator trying to save up money for?
2. What did the narrator start doing to improve their spending habits?
3. What was the biggest surprise in the narrator's spending habits?
4. How did the narrator change their spending habits?
5. How has changing their spending habits helped the narrator?

Conversations Starters:

1. What are some common spending habits that people have that can negatively impact their financial situation?
2. How do you approach budgeting and tracking your spending? What tools or methods do you use?
3. What are some effective strategies for saving money on everyday expenses?
4. Do you prefer shopping in-store or online? Why?
5. How do you avoid impulse purchases when shopping?
6. What are some of the biggest challenges you face when it comes to saving money?
7. How important is it to you to have a savings plan and emergency fund? Why?
8. Have you ever tried a "no-spend" challenge? How did it go?
9. What role do personal values and goals play in your spending and saving habits?
10. How can society as a whole encourage better spending and saving habits?

UNIT 8: MONEY AND FINANCE

Story 04: Retirement

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|--------------|------------------|
| 1. Drastic | 6. Socializing |
| 2. Laid-back | 7. Pursue |
| 3. Chaos | 8. Grateful |
| 4. Diversity | 9. Opportunities |
| 5. Array | 10. Adjust |

I retired a few years ago and moved to a small beach town after spending my whole life in a big city. The change in my lifestyle has been drastic, but overall, I'm very happy with my decision.

Living in a small town has its pros and cons. On the one hand, everything is much more relaxed and laid-back. I no longer have to deal with the stress and chaos of big city life. I can take my time with things, whether it's walking on the beach, gardening in my backyard, or simply enjoying a cup of coffee on my front porch.

On the other hand, there are times when I miss the energy and excitement of city life. I miss the diversity of people and cultures, and the endless array of things to do and see. It can also be challenging at times to adjust to small-town life, especially when it comes to socializing and making new friends.

Despite these challenges, I'm grateful for my retirement and the opportunities it has brought me. I've been able to travel more, spend more time with family and friends, and pursue hobbies and interests that I never had time for before. Overall, I wouldn't trade my new lifestyle for anything.

Comprehension Questions:

1. Where did the narrator move after retiring?
2. How has the narrator's lifestyle changed since retiring?
3. What are some of the pros of living in a small beach town?
4. What are some of the cons of living in a small beach town?
5. How has retirement affected the narrator's ability to pursue hobbies and interests?

Conversations Starters:

1. When do you hope to retire? How did you arrive at that decision?
2. What are some of the biggest challenges that retirees face in terms of financial planning?
3. What is your ideal retirement lifestyle? What would you do if you had unlimited time and resources?
4. How important is it to have a retirement plan in place? What should be included in a retirement plan?
5. How do you plan to stay active and engaged during retirement?
6. Have you thought about where you would like to live during retirement? What factors are important to you when choosing a retirement location?
7. How important is it to you to have a sense of purpose during retirement? What are some ways to maintain a sense of purpose after leaving the workforce?
8. What are some common misconceptions about retirement? How can they be addressed?
9. Have you ever considered retiring abroad? What are some pros and cons of retiring in another country?
10. What advice would you give to someone who is just starting to think about their retirement plans?

UNIT 8: MONEY AND FINANCE

Story 05: Winning the lottery

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|------------------|--------------------------|
| 1. Apprehension | 6. Diversified portfolio |
| 2. Drastic | 7. Financial future |
| 3. Burdened | 8. Life-changing event |
| 4. Peace of mind | 9. Joy |
| 5. Newfound | 10. Means |

If I won the lottery, it would be a life-changing event for me. I would feel a mix of excitement and apprehension, knowing that my life was about to take a drastic turn.

The first thing I would do is pay off any outstanding debts or bills that I owe. This would provide me with a sense of security and peace of mind, knowing that I was no longer burdened by financial obligations.

Next, I would take a long vacation to a tropical destination. I've always dreamed of lying on a beautiful beach and soaking up the sun, and winning the lottery would finally give me the means to do so.

After my vacation, I would start to think about how I could use my newfound wealth to help others. I would donate a portion of my winnings to various charities and causes that are important to me, such as education, healthcare, and the environment.

Finally, I would invest the rest of my winnings in a diversified portfolio, so that I could continue to grow my wealth and ensure a secure financial future for myself and my loved ones.

While winning the lottery would certainly be a life-changing event, I know that money can't buy happiness. Ultimately, it's the people in my life and the experiences I have that bring me the most joy.

Comprehension Questions:

1. How would winning the lottery change the narrator's life?
2. What would be the first thing the narrator would do with their winnings?
3. Where would the narrator go on vacation with their winnings?
4. How would the narrator use their winnings to help others?
5. What is more important to the narrator than money?

Conversations Starters:

1. What would you do if you won the lottery? How would your life change?
2. Do you think winning the lottery would make you happier? Why or why not?
3. How would winning the lottery affect your relationships with friends and family?
4. What are some of the potential downsides to winning the lottery?
5. If you could have one wish granted, what would it be and why?
6. Have you ever had a dream or goal that you thought was impossible? Did you end up achieving it?
7. How important is it to have goals and aspirations in life? What are some of your current goals?
8. What is something you've always wanted to learn or try, but haven't had the chance to yet?
9. Have you ever taken a big risk in order to pursue a dream or goal? How did it turn out?
10. What advice would you give to someone who is struggling to pursue their dreams?

UNIT 9: TRAVELING AND CULTURE

STORY 1: Traveling

STORY 2: International festivals

STORY 3: International cuisine

STORY 4: Medical tourism

STORY 5: Landmarks and historical sites

UNIT 9: TRAVELING AND CULTURE

Story 01: Traveling

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|-----------------|----------------------|
| 1. Iconic | 6. Adventure |
| 2. Day trip | 7. Cuisine |
| 3. Landmark | 8. Language barriers |
| 4. Invigorating | 9. Breathtaking |
| 5. Hiccups | 10. Ways of life |

I recently returned from a European vacation, and it was an incredible experience. During my trip, I visited several countries, including France, Italy, and Spain.

In France, I visited Paris and saw the Eiffel Tower, the Louvre Museum, and Notre-Dame Cathedral. I also took a day trip to Versailles to see the palace and gardens.

In Italy, I spent time in Rome, Florence, and Venice. I visited iconic landmarks such as the Colosseum, the Vatican, and the canals of Venice. I also tried many delicious Italian dishes, such as pizza, pasta, and gelato.

In Spain, I spent most of my time in Barcelona, where I saw the famous architecture of Antoni Gaudi, including the Sagrada Familia and Park Guell. I also visited the beach and enjoyed the local cuisine.

One of the most memorable experiences of my trip was hiking in the Swiss Alps. The views were breathtaking, and the fresh mountain air was invigorating.

Overall, my trip was amazing, and I learned a lot about different cultures and ways of life. While there were a few hiccups, such as a delayed flight and some language barriers, these challenges only added to the adventure.

Comprehension Questions:

1. Which countries did the narrator visit on their European vacation?
2. What landmarks did the narrator see in Paris?
3. What types of food did the narrator try in Italy?
4. What was the most memorable experience of the narrator's trip?
5. Did the narrator encounter any problems during their trip?

Conversations Starters:

1. What has been your favorite travel destination so far? Why did you enjoy it?
2. Do you prefer to travel alone or with others? Why?
3. What is your favorite way to travel (e.g. by plane, train, car, etc.)? Why?
4. What is your biggest travel-related pet peeve?
5. What is the most adventurous thing you've ever done while traveling?
6. Do you think it's important to learn some of the local language before traveling to a foreign country? Why or why not?
7. What are some of the benefits and drawbacks of traveling to popular tourist destinations?
8. What is something you always make sure to pack when traveling?
9. What is a place you've always wanted to visit but haven't had the chance to yet? Why do you want to go there?
10. What advice would you give to someone who is planning their first big trip?

UNIT 9: TRAVELING AND CULTURE

Story 02: International festivals

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|--------------------|-------------------|
| 1. Studying abroad | 6. Floats |
| 2. Festival | 7. Marching bands |
| 3. International | 8. Immersion |
| 4. Lederhosen | 9. Bratwurst |
| 5. Dirndls | 10. Atmosphere |

During my semester studying abroad in a foreign country, I had the opportunity to attend and participate in a famous international festival known as Oktoberfest.

Oktoberfest is a two-week-long festival that takes place in Munich, Germany every year. The festival is primarily known for its celebration of beer and German culture, with various events and activities taking place throughout the city.

One of the most memorable experiences of the festival was attending the opening day parade. The streets were filled with people dressed in traditional German clothing, including lederhosen and dirndls. There were floats, marching bands, and horse-drawn carriages all decorated in the colors of the Bavarian flag.

After the parade, my friends and I visited one of the many beer tents set up around the festival grounds. The tent was crowded, with people standing on benches and singing along to traditional German songs. We enjoyed some of the local beer and food, such as pretzels and bratwurst, while taking in the lively atmosphere.

Overall, Oktoberfest was an incredible experience that allowed me to immerse myself in German culture and make new friends from around the world.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is Oktoberfest, and where does it take place?
2. What is the festival primarily known for?
3. What was the most memorable part of the festival for the narrator?
4. What did the narrator and their friends do while at one of the beer tents?
5. How did the narrator feel about their experience at Oktoberfest?

Conversations Starters:

1. What is your favorite international festival, and why?
2. Have you ever attended a famous international festival? If so, which one(s)?
3. Do you think it's important for people to experience different cultures through festivals and celebrations? Why or why not?
4. What are some common themes or traditions that you see in festivals from different cultures?
5. What are some challenges or drawbacks of attending large festivals or events?
6. Do you think international festivals can help promote tourism and boost local economies? Why or why not?
7. What is the role of music and dance in international festivals?
8. How have international festivals evolved over time, and what impact has technology had on them?
9. What are some lesser-known international festivals that you would like to attend?
10. What advice would you give to someone who is attending an international festival for the first time?

UNIT 9: TRAVELING AND CULTURE

Story 03: International cuisine

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|--------------------------------|------------------------|
| 1. International food festival | 6. Korean barbecue |
| 2. Ingredients | 7. Fermented bean dish |
| 3. Spices | 8. Tres leches cake |
| 4. Thai chicken curry | 9. Socialize |
| 5. Indian samosa | 10. Love of food |

I recently had the opportunity to attend an international food festival at a local park. It was a great experience to try new foods from different cultures and learn about the different ingredients and spices used in each dish.

One of my favorite dishes was a spicy Thai chicken curry. The combination of the creamy coconut milk and the spicy chili peppers made for a delicious and complex flavor. I also tried a savory Indian samosa, filled with spiced potatoes and peas, and served with a tangy tamarind sauce. Another standout dish was a sweet and sticky Korean barbecue, with tender strips of beef that were marinated in soy sauce, sesame oil, and brown sugar.

There were a few dishes that I wasn't as fond of, such as a fermented bean dish from China that had a strong, pungent odor and a sour taste. I also tried a dessert from Mexico called tres leches cake, which was too sweet and rich for my taste.

Overall, the food festival was a great experience, and I enjoyed learning about different cultures and trying new foods. It was also a fun opportunity to socialize and meet new people who shared a love of food.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What was the narrator's favorite dish at the food festival?
2. What were some other dishes that the narrator tried and enjoyed?
3. Was there any food that the narrator did not like? Why?
4. How did the narrator feel about the overall experience at the food festival?
5. What was one thing the narrator learned about different cultures through the food festival?

Conversations Starters:

1. What is your favorite type of international cuisine, and why?
2. Have you ever tried a food from another culture that you couldn't eat? What was it, and why couldn't you eat it?
3. How important is it to try new foods and explore different cuisines?
4. What are some common ingredients or spices used in international cuisine that you enjoy?
5. Have you ever traveled specifically to experience a certain type of food or cuisine? Where did you go, and what did you try?
6. What is your favorite dish to cook at home, and what are the ingredients and spices used in it?
7. What are some foods from your own culture that you think people should try?
8. How do food and culture intersect, and what role does food play in different cultures?
9. Do you think there are health benefits to eating a diverse range of foods from different cultures?
10. How has your relationship with food changed over time, and what have been some influential experiences or factors?

UNIT 9: TRAVELING AND CULTURE

Story 04: Medical tourism

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| 1. Medical tourism | 6. Cultural immersion |
| 2. Chronic pain | 7. Practical solution |
| 3. Minimally invasive surgery | 8. Lack of access |
| 4. Quality of care | 9. Modern and well-equipped |
| 5. Professional and attentive | 10. Local culture |

I have had experience with medical tourism, and it was a decision that had a significant impact on my life. I had been struggling with chronic back pain for years, and the cost of medical treatments in my home country was simply too high. After doing some research, I decided to travel to Thailand to seek treatment.

The overall experience was positive, and I was surprised by the high quality of care I received. I underwent a minimally invasive spinal surgery, which had a significant impact on my pain levels and allowed me to resume my normal activities. The hospital where I received treatment was modern and well-equipped, and the staff were professional and attentive.

Aside from the medical treatment, I also had the opportunity to explore Thailand and experience the local culture. I visited temples, tried new foods, and met some friendly locals. The combination of medical treatment and cultural immersion made for a unique and memorable experience.

Overall, medical tourism was a practical solution for my medical needs, and I would recommend it to others who are facing high medical costs or lack of access to quality care in their home countries.

Comprehension Questions:

1. Why did the narrator choose to seek medical treatment abroad?
2. What was the narrator's medical condition?
3. What type of medical treatment did the narrator receive?
4. What was the quality of care like in the hospital where the narrator received treatment?
5. What other experiences did the narrator have while abroad for medical tourism?

Conversations Starters:

1. Have you ever considered seeking medical treatment abroad? Why or why not?
2. What are some factors that might lead someone to pursue medical tourism?
3. What are some risks or challenges associated with medical tourism?
4. What are some advantages or benefits of seeking medical treatment abroad?
5. What is your opinion on the quality of healthcare in your own country?
6. What are some challenges or issues with the healthcare system in your country?
7. What are some potential solutions to improve healthcare in your country?
8. Do you think healthcare should be a basic human right? Why or why not?
9. What is your opinion on the cost of healthcare in your country?
10. Have you ever had a positive or negative experience with healthcare in your own country? Can you describe it?

UNIT 9: TRAVELING AND CULTURE

Story 05: Landmarks and historical sites

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|--------------------|-----------------------|
| 1. Landmark | 6. Perseverance |
| 2. Historical site | 7. Sheer scale |
| 3. Awe-inspiring | 8. Breathtaking views |
| 4. Fortifications | 9. National pride |
| 5. Ingenuity | 10. Cultural heritage |

I have been fortunate enough to visit many memorable landmarks and historical sites in my travels, but one that stands out to me is the Great Wall of China. I visited the wall during a trip to Beijing, and it was truly awe-inspiring to see in person.

The Great Wall is a series of fortifications that stretches across northern China, originally built to protect against invading armies. It is one of the world's largest man-made structures and a testament to human ingenuity and perseverance. Walking along the wall, I was struck by the sheer scale of the structure and the breathtaking views of the surrounding countryside.

In addition to its historical significance, the Great Wall is also an important cultural landmark in China. The wall has been a symbol of Chinese strength and unity for centuries, and it remains a source of national pride to this day.

Overall, visiting the Great Wall was a once-in-a-lifetime experience that I will never forget. It was a humbling reminder of the power of human achievement and the importance of preserving our cultural heritage for future generations.

Comprehension Questions:

1. Where is the Great Wall of China located?
2. Why was the Great Wall originally built?
3. What was the narrator's reaction upon seeing the Great Wall in person?
4. What is the Great Wall a symbol of in Chinese culture?
5. How did the narrator feel about the overall experience of visiting the Great Wall?

Conversations Starters:

1. What are some famous landmarks or historical sites that you would like to visit one day?
2. Have you ever visited a famous landmark or historical site? If so, which one(s) and what was your experience like?
3. What are some historical sites or landmarks that are particularly important or significant in your country's history?
4. Do you think it's important to preserve historical landmarks and sites for future generations? Why or why not?
5. What are some challenges associated with maintaining and preserving historical landmarks and sites?
6. How do you think tourism affects historical landmarks and sites?
7. What are some of the benefits of visiting famous landmarks and historical sites?
8. How do famous landmarks and historical sites contribute to our understanding of different cultures and societies?
9. Have you ever had a negative experience while visiting a famous landmark or historical site? Can you describe it?
10. What is your opinion on the commercialization of famous landmarks and historical sites?

UNIT 10: SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

STORY 1: Artificial intelligence

STORY 2: Space exploration

STORY 3: Alternative energy

STORY 4: Electric vehicles

STORY 5: Virtual reality

UNIT 10: SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

Story 01: Artificial intelligence

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------|
| 1. Potential | 6. Data analysis |
| 2. Application | 7. Natural disasters |
| 3. Healthcare | 8. Inequalities |
| 4. Diagnoses | 9. Ethical considerations |
| 5. Environmental sustainability | 10. Exacerbate |

As a senior AI researcher, I strongly believe that AI has the potential to change the world for the better in numerous ways. One of the most exciting applications of AI is in the field of healthcare. AI can help doctors and medical professionals make more accurate diagnoses, identify potential health risks, and develop more effective treatment plans. In addition, AI-powered technologies can help improve patient outcomes and reduce healthcare costs.

Another area where AI can make a positive impact is in environmental sustainability. By analyzing large amounts of data and identifying patterns and trends, AI can help us better understand complex environmental issues and develop more effective solutions. For example, AI can help us monitor air and water quality, identify areas at risk of natural disasters, and optimize energy use.

Of course, there are also a number of issues and challenges that we need to address as we continue to develop and deploy AI technologies. One of the biggest concerns is the potential for AI to exacerbate existing social and economic inequalities. Additionally, there are concerns around privacy, security, and ethical considerations in AI development and deployment.

Overall, I believe that AI has the potential to be a powerful force for good in the world. As researchers, we need to be mindful of the challenges and risks associated with AI, and work to address these issues as we continue to push the boundaries of what's possible.

Comprehension Questions:

1. In what ways can AI be applied in the field of healthcare?
2. How can AI help us address environmental issues?
3. What are some of the challenges associated with AI development and deployment?
4. What are some potential risks associated with AI?
5. How can researchers help ensure that AI is used for good?

Conversations Starters:

1. What are your thoughts on the potential impact of AI on our daily lives?
2. What are some movies or TV shows that feature AI? Do you think they accurately represent the capabilities and limitations of AI?
3. What are some potential benefits of AI in various industries, such as healthcare, finance, and manufacturing?
4. How do you think AI could help address global challenges, such as climate change and poverty?
5. What are some potential risks and challenges associated with the development and use of AI?
6. Do you think AI could replace human jobs in the future? Why or why not?
7. How can we ensure that AI is developed and used in an ethical and responsible manner?
8. Have you had any personal experiences with AI technology, such as using virtual assistants or chatbots?
9. What are some cultural or social implications of AI, such as the impact on privacy, security, and human rights?
10. What are your hopes and concerns for the future of AI?

UNIT 10: SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

Story 02: Space exploration

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|---------------------------|-------------------|
| 1. Fascinating | 6. Space medicine |
| 2. Gaze | 7. Ingenuity |
| 3. Insights | 8. Complexity |
| 4. Practical applications | 9. Cosmos |
| 5. Astrobiology | 10. Ambition |

Space exploration has always been fascinating to me. As a child, I would gaze at the night sky, dreaming of one day traveling among the stars. The more I learn about space, the more I realize how much there is left to discover.

Space exploration is important for many reasons. First, it expands our knowledge of the universe and helps us to better understand our place in it. With each mission, we gain new insights into the workings of the cosmos and discover new planets, stars, and galaxies.

Space exploration also drives technological innovation. Many of the technologies developed for space travel, such as satellite communication and GPS, have practical applications on Earth. Additionally, space exploration has inspired new fields of science and engineering, from astrobiology to space medicine.

Finally, space exploration is a symbol of human achievement and ambition. It challenges us to push the limits of what we can achieve and inspires us to dream big. As we continue to explore the cosmos, we gain a deeper appreciation for the beauty and complexity of the universe, and for the ingenuity and perseverance of the human spirit.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What inspired the writer to dream of becoming an astronaut?
2. What are some benefits of space exploration for our understanding of the universe?
3. How has space exploration driven technological innovation on Earth?
4. What are some new fields of science and engineering inspired by space exploration?
5. What does space exploration symbolize for human achievement and ambition?

Conversations Starters:

1. What do you think are some benefits of space exploration for humanity?
2. Do you think it's important to explore space or should we focus on solving problems on Earth first?
3. If given the opportunity, would you want to travel to space? Why or why not?
4. What do you think are some ethical considerations surrounding space exploration, such as mining asteroids or terraforming planets?
5. What do you think is the likelihood of finding alien life in our universe?
6. How do you think humanity should react if we were to discover alien life?
7. Do you believe in UFO sightings and alien encounters? Why or why not?
8. How do you think space exploration will evolve in the next 50 years?
9. What do you think are some challenges of sending humans on long-duration space missions, such as to Mars or beyond?
10. Do you think space exploration should be funded by governments or by private companies? Why or why not?

UNIT 10: SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

Story 03: Alternative energy

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------|
| 1. Environmental engineer | 6. Fossil fuels |
| 2. Alternative energy | 7. Greenhouse gas emissions |
| 3. Renewable sources | 8. Innovative |
| 4. Climate change | 9. Practical |
| 5. Mitigate | 10. Efficient |

I am an environmental engineer and my mission is to find alternative sources of energy to help protect our planet. I work on researching and developing new technologies that harness energy from renewable sources such as wind, solar, and geothermal power.

One of the things that drew me to this field is the urgent need for solutions to mitigate the impact of climate change. I am passionate about protecting the environment and preserving it for future generations. I believe that as an engineer, I can make a significant contribution towards creating a more sustainable world.

My work involves designing, testing, and implementing new energy systems that are both practical and efficient. I collaborate with other engineers and scientists to find innovative ways to reduce our reliance on fossil fuels and minimize greenhouse gas emissions. It's a challenging and rewarding job, and I feel like I am making a difference in the world.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is the mission of the environmental engineer?
2. What are some renewable sources of energy the engineer is working with?
3. Why did the engineer decide to pursue this field?
4. Who does the engineer collaborate with to find new ways to reduce greenhouse gas emissions?
5. How does the engineer feel about their work?

Conversations Starters:

1. What are some of the most promising alternative sources of energy?
2. What are some challenges to implementing alternative energy sources on a large scale?
3. Do you think individuals can make a difference in reducing their carbon footprint?
4. What is the responsibility of governments and corporations in promoting alternative energy and protecting the environment?
5. Have you personally made any changes in your lifestyle to reduce your impact on the environment?
6. What role do you think education plays in promoting sustainability and protecting the environment?
7. How important is it to protect natural habitats and biodiversity?
8. Are there any environmental policies or initiatives in your country that you feel are particularly effective?
9. How do you think climate change will impact future generations?
10. What is the role of technology in addressing environmental issues?

UNIT 10: SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

Story 04: Electric vehicles

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|---------------------------|-------------------|
| 1. Contemplating | 6. Affordability |
| 2. Environmental benefits | 7. Range |
| 3. Harmful pollutants | 8. Convenience |
| 4. Global warming | 9. Sustainability |
| 5. Charging stations | 10. Priorities |

I'm in the market for a new car and I'm contemplating between an electric car or a regular gasoline car. The main reason I'm considering an electric car is because of the environmental benefits. Electric cars are much more environmentally friendly than traditional gasoline cars. They emit no harmful pollutants and contribute significantly less to global warming. Additionally, with the increasing availability of charging stations, the inconvenience of having to find a charging station is becoming less of an issue.

On the other hand, I'm also considering a traditional gasoline car because of the cost. Gasoline cars are generally more affordable than electric cars. They also have a longer range and are easier to fill up at any gas station.

Ultimately, I think it comes down to personal priorities. If environmental sustainability is important to you, then an electric car might be the better choice. However, if cost and convenience are more important, then a traditional gasoline car might be the better choice.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What are the environmental benefits of an electric car?
2. Are charging stations becoming more or less available?
3. What is the main advantage of a traditional gasoline car over an electric car?
4. What should the decision to buy an electric or gasoline car ultimately come down to?
5. Which type of car might be a better choice for someone who prioritizes environmental sustainability?

Conversations Starters:

1. What type of car do you currently drive? Why did you choose this particular car?
2. What is your dream car? Why do you want it?
3. How important is fuel efficiency to you when choosing a car?
4. Would you prefer a car with more advanced technological features or a simpler car that is easier to maintain?
5. How often do you use your car on a daily basis?
6. Are you interested in electric or hybrid cars? Why or why not?
7. How much do you think people should spend on a car?
8. How do you feel about self-driving cars? Would you be comfortable riding in one?
9. Have you ever owned a luxury car? How was your experience?
10. Do you think car ownership will decrease in the future as people turn to ride-sharing services and public transportation? Why or why not?

UNIT 10: SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

Story 05: Virtual reality

Key Lesson Vocabulary & Expressions:

- | | |
|--------------------|----------------|
| 1. Skeptical | 6. Prohibitive |
| 2. Immersive | 7. Ethics |
| 3. Simulations | 8. Propaganda |
| 4. Motion sickness | 9. Manipulate |
| 5. Addiction | 10. Downsides |

As an avid technology user, I have experimented with virtual reality (VR) before. While there are some benefits to using VR, I remain skeptical of its long-term impact on society. One of the main pros of VR is its ability to provide immersive experiences, such as in gaming or simulations. It can also be used in education or therapy to simulate real-life scenarios.

However, I also see several potential cons. For one, extended use of VR can cause discomfort or motion sickness. Moreover, it can be isolating, cutting users off from the real world and social interaction. Additionally, there is concern about the effect on mental health and addiction. Another potential problem is the cost of VR equipment, which can be prohibitive for many individuals and communities.

I also have concerns about the ethical implications of VR. With the ability to create highly realistic simulations, it raises questions about how far we should go in recreating experiences or environments that could potentially be harmful or exploitative. Furthermore, there is the danger of VR being used for propaganda or to manipulate individuals in ways that they are not aware of.

Overall, while there are certainly benefits to VR, I believe that we should approach its use with caution and be aware of its potential downsides.

Comprehension Questions:

1. What is virtual reality?
2. What are some benefits of using virtual reality?
3. What are some potential negative effects of using virtual reality?
4. How can virtual reality be isolating?
5. What are some ethical concerns about virtual reality?

Conversations Starters:

1. Have you ever tried virtual reality technology? What was your experience like?
2. How do you think virtual reality will change the way we live our lives in the future?
3. Do you think virtual reality will become a major part of entertainment, education, or other industries? Why or why not?
4. What are some potential drawbacks or risks associated with virtual reality?
5. How might virtual reality impact the way we interact with each other on a social level?
6. Do you think virtual reality will ever fully replace traditional forms of entertainment or education? Why or why not?
7. How might virtual reality be used in healthcare or therapy?
8. Are you excited about the possibilities of virtual reality, or do you think it's overhyped? Why?
9. What ethical concerns might arise with the use of virtual reality technology?
10. How do you see virtual reality evolving and improving in the coming years?

Vocabulary and Expressions Exercises

UNIT 1: FAMILY AND RELATIONSHIPS

UNIT 2: HOME AND NEIGHBORHOOD

UNIT 3: ENTERTAINMENT

UNIT 4: HEALTH AND WELLNESS

UNIT 5: WORK AND CAREER

UNIT 6: SOCIAL MEDIA AND THE INTERNET

UNIT 7: SPORTS

UNIT 8: MONEY AND FINANCE

UNIT 9: TRAVELING AND CULTURE

UNIT 10: SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

UNIT 1: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 01 - Family

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|-----------------------------|-------|
| 1. tight-knit | _____ |
| 2. catching up | _____ |
| 3. role models | _____ |
| 4. passionate | _____ |
| 5. construction | _____ |
| 6. daredevil | _____ |
| 7. scraped knees | _____ |
| 8. successful | _____ |
| 9. pursue | _____ |
| 10. have each other's backs | _____ |

- A. Follow or chase after something or someone
- B. A reckless person who enjoys taking risks
- C. Injuries to the skin caused by falling or rubbing against a hard surface
- D. Achieving the desired outcome or results
- E. Closely bound together
- F. People whose behavior, attitudes, and achievements serve as an example for others
- G. Exchanging updates or news with someone
- H. To support and defend one another in times of need
- I. Having or showing strong feelings or beliefs about something
- J. The building of something, typically a large structure

UNIT 1: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 02 - Marriage

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|---------------------|-------|
| 1. Independent | _____ |
| 2. Compromise | _____ |
| 3. Social life | _____ |
| 4. Merge | _____ |
| 5. Learning process | _____ |
| 6. Balance | _____ |
| 7. Rewarding | _____ |
| 8. Positive | _____ |
| 9. Negative | _____ |
| 10. Significant | _____ |

A. Important or meaningful

B. Giving a feeling of satisfaction or enjoyment

C. Unfavorable or pessimistic in nature

D. The act of acquiring knowledge or skills through experience, study, or teaching

E. To combine or blend two or more things together into one

F. To maintain a stable and equal distribution of time or resources

G. Having the ability to do things on one's own without the help of others

H. Favorable or optimistic in nature

I. The activities one engages in with others, such as friends and family

J. The act of finding a middle ground between two different viewpoints or opinions

UNIT 1: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 03 - Parenting

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|--------------------|-------|
| 1. Perseverance | _____ |
| 2. Empathy | _____ |
| 3. Self-sufficient | _____ |
| 4. Comfort zone | _____ |
| 5. Prioritize | _____ |
| 6. Values | _____ |
| 7. Determination | _____ |
| 8. Independent | _____ |
| 9. Supportive | _____ |
| 10. Passion | _____ |

- A. The act of making decisions firmly and purposefully
- B. The ability to continue trying to achieve a goal despite setbacks or obstacles
- C. The act of providing encouragement or emotional help to someone
- D. A strong and barely controllable emotion for something or someone
- E. The ability to understand and share the feelings of others
- F. Principles or beliefs that a person or group considers to be important
- G. The ability to provide for oneself without outside assistance
- H. Free from outside control or authority
- I. The act of making something a priority and allocating resources accordingly
- J. A state of familiarity and ease within one's own routine or surroundings

UNIT 1: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 04 - Friendship

Match the terms with the definitions

- | | |
|-------------------------|-------|
| 1. Engaged | _____ |
| 2. Biology | _____ |
| 3. Evolved | _____ |
| 4. Trust | _____ |
| 5. Compassionate | _____ |
| 6. Mundane | _____ |
| 7. Countless | _____ |
| 8. Celebrate | _____ |
| 9. To be someone's rock | _____ |
| 10. Hilarious | _____ |

- A. A science that deals with the study of living organisms and their interactions with one another and their environment
- B. To be a source of support and stability for someone in difficult times
- C. Having a sense of humor and causing laughter
- D. Having a deep awareness of and sympathy for another's suffering
- E. The act of recognizing and showing appreciation for an important event or achievement
- F. The state of being actively involved or occupied
- G. Endless or immeasurable in number or quantity
- H. The act of changing and developing over time
- I. To have confidence in and rely on someone
- J. Lacking interest or excitement; dull and ordinary

UNIT 1: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 05 - Love and dating

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|-------------------------|-------|
| 1. Blind date | _____ |
| 2. Hesitant | _____ |
| 3. Benefit of the doubt | _____ |
| 4. Red flag | _____ |
| 5. Ex-girlfriends | _____ |
| 6. Due diligence | _____ |
| 7. Suitable match | _____ |
| 8. Proceeded to | _____ |
| 9. Obvious discomfort | _____ |
| 10. Disappointed | _____ |

- A. A person who would be a good romantic partner.
- B. A warning sign indicating a potential problem.
- C. Giving someone a chance despite some doubts or suspicions.
- D. Thoroughly researching and investigating something or someone.
- E. Clear physical or emotional unease or pain.
- F. Feeling let down or unhappy with something.
- G. A date with someone you have never met before.
- H. Went ahead and did something.
- I. Women who were previously in a romantic relationship with someone.
- J. Showing uncertainty or reluctance to do something.

UNIT 2: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 01 - Homes

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|-------------------|-------|
| 1. Spacious | _____ |
| 2. Fond memories | _____ |
| 3. Hide and seek | _____ |
| 4. Unique | _____ |
| 5. Built-in | _____ |
| 6. Canopy bed | _____ |
| 7. Hues | _____ |
| 8. Messiest | _____ |
| 9. Bean bag chair | _____ |
| 10. Soak | _____ |

- A. A color or shade of color.
- B. A bed with a decorative covering or canopy.
- C. To lie or be in a bath for a long time.
- D. Having ample space or roomy.
- E. A type of chair filled with small pellets of foam.
- F. One of a kind or special in some way.
- G. Pleasant or enjoyable recollections of past experiences.
- H. A game where one person hides and others seek them out.
- I. Very untidy or disorganized.
- J. Permanently fixed or incorporated into a structure or object.

UNIT 2: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 02 - Neighborhoods

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|-------------------------|-------|
| 1. Bustling | _____ |
| 2. Chatter | _____ |
| 3. Enriching | _____ |
| 4. Galleries | _____ |
| 5. Broadway | _____ |
| 6. Center of the action | _____ |
| 7. Tranquility | _____ |
| 8. Skyline | _____ |
| 9. Chaos | _____ |
| 10. Balcony | _____ |

- A. A platform projecting from the wall of a building, typically with a railing and used as a place to relax outdoors.
- B. A street in Manhattan known for its theaters and shows.
- C. The outline of a city's buildings against the sky.
- D. Complete disorder and confusion.
- E. Full of energetic and noisy activity.
- F. Informal talk, often rapid and constant.
- G. Adding value or enhancing one's knowledge or experience.
- H. Places where art is displayed and sold.
- I. The main focus or busiest area of activity.
- J. A state of calm or peacefulness.

UNIT 2: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 03 - Museums

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|-----------------|-------|
| 1. Vast | _____ |
| 2. Exhibits | _____ |
| 3. Evolution | _____ |
| 4. Ancestors | _____ |
| 5. Mind-blowing | _____ |
| 6. DNA | _____ |
| 7. Iconic | _____ |
| 8. Pivotal | _____ |
| 9. Feats | _____ |
| 10. Engineering | _____ |

A. The process by which different kinds of living organisms are believed to have developed from earlier forms during the history of the earth.

B. A group or individual from whom one is descended.

C. A display or collection of objects or items.

D. A branch of science and technology concerned with the design, building, and use of engines, machines, and structures.

E. The genetic material present in all living organisms.

F. Something that is very impressive, stunning, or astonishing.

G. Of crucial importance in relation to the development or success of something else.

H. Something remarkable or impressive that has been achieved.

I. Widely recognized and well-established.

J. Very large or extensive.

UNIT 2: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 04 - Parks

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|-----------------------|-------|
| 1. Unwind | _____ |
| 2. Benches | _____ |
| 3. Surroundings | _____ |
| 4. Nieces | _____ |
| 5. Nephews | _____ |
| 6. Expending | _____ |
| 7. Picnic | _____ |
| 8. Serene | _____ |
| 9. Tranquility | _____ |
| 10. Hustle and bustle | _____ |

- A. The act of using up or spending resources, such as time or money.
- B. A way to relax or de-stress, often by doing something enjoyable or engaging in a calming environment.
- C. Places where people can sit down, often found in parks or other outdoor spaces.
- D. The state of being calm, peaceful, and free from disturbance.
- E. The opposite of hustle and bustle; a state of quiet, stillness, and peacefulness.
- F. The sounds and activity of a busy area, usually a city center or commercial district.
- G. Female children of one's siblings.
- H. The area immediately surrounding a person or place, including physical and social factors.
- I. Male children of one's siblings.
- J. A meal eaten outdoors, usually in a park or other scenic location.

UNIT 2: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 05 - Cafes and restaurants

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|-----------------------------|-------|
| 1. Cozy | _____ |
| 2. Stumbled upon | _____ |
| 3. Inviting | _____ |
| 4. Delicious treats | _____ |
| 5. Gourmet | _____ |
| 6. Poached egg | _____ |
| 7. Flavorful | _____ |
| 8. Regulars | _____ |
| 9. Strike up a conversation | _____ |
| 10. Rejuvenated | _____ |

A. A relaxed and comfortable atmosphere, often associated with small spaces and warm decor.

B. To find something by accident or without planning.

C. Attractive or welcoming, often used to describe places or situations that make people feel comfortable and included.

D. High-quality food and drinks, often associated with expensive or specialized ingredients.

E. A way of cooking eggs in boiling water, without a shell.

F. Rich, tasty, and full of flavor, often used to describe food and beverages.

G. People who frequent a particular place, often used to describe regular customers at a business.

H. To start a conversation with someone, often in a friendly or informal way.

I. To feel refreshed, renewed, and full of energy.

J. Sweet or savory items that are enjoyable to eat, often associated with desserts or snacks.

UNIT 3: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 01 - Movies and TV shows

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|-------------------------|-------|
| 1. Fast-paced | _____ |
| 2. Thrilling | _____ |
| 3. Stunts | _____ |
| 4. Come out on top | _____ |
| 5. Impossible situation | _____ |
| 6. Escape from reality | _____ |
| 7. Special effects | _____ |
| 8. Choreography | _____ |
| 9. Cinematography | _____ |
| 10. Sequences | _____ |

A. The art of designing and arranging dance movements for a performance.

B. A series of related scenes or events, often used to describe action scenes in movies or TV shows.

C. The use of visual and mechanical techniques to create illusions or enhance the realism of a scene.

D. The process of filming a movie or TV show, including the camera work, lighting, and framing of shots.

E. Something that is exciting, suspenseful, or adrenaline-inducing, often used to describe action scenes or intense moments in movies or TV shows.

F. An action or feat that requires skill and daring, often performed by stunt performers in movies or TV shows.

G. To be victorious or successful, especially in a difficult or competitive situation.

H. A situation that seems impossible to solve or overcome.

I. The act of seeking distraction or relief from one's problems or circumstances, often through entertainment.

J. Characterized by a rapid and lively pace, often used to describe action scenes or fast-moving plots.

UNIT 3: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 02 - Books

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|------------------|-------|
| 1. Weaves | _____ |
| 2. Narrative | _____ |
| 3. Masterful | _____ |
| 4. Sacrifices | _____ |
| 5. Bravery | _____ |
| 6. Resistance | _____ |
| 7. Occupation | _____ |
| 8. Admiration | _____ |
| 9. Resilience | _____ |
| 10. Stay with me | _____ |

- A. The ability to recover from difficult situations and overcome adversity.
- B. The act of putting the needs or desires of others before your own, often at great personal cost.
- C. A feeling of deep respect or approval for someone or something.
- D. The use of words to tell a story or convey a message.
- E. The act of fighting against an authority or oppressor, often in pursuit of freedom or justice.
- F. The control or possession of a territory by a foreign power or military force.
- G. To combine different elements or threads together to create a larger whole.
- H. Displaying great skill or talent in a particular area, often used to describe artistic or creative works.
- I. The ability to persist in the face of challenges or obstacles, often characterized by determination and strength of character.
- J. A phrase used to describe something that has made a lasting impression or impact.

UNIT 3: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 03 - Music

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|---------------------------|-------|
| 1. Die-hard | _____ |
| 2. Bubblegum pop | _____ |
| 3. Catchy hooks | _____ |
| 4. Upbeat melodies | _____ |
| 5. Raw energy | _____ |
| 6. Musicianship | _____ |
| 7. Artistry | _____ |
| 8. Intricate guitar solos | _____ |
| 9. Soaring vocal melodies | _____ |
| 10. Speak to my soul | _____ |

A. A type of pop music characterized by its light, catchy melodies and simple, saccharine lyrics.

B. A strong emotional connection or resonance with a particular type of music or artist.

C. The technical ability and skill of a musician or group of musicians.

D. The use of words or melodies that are easy to remember and that "hook" the listener.

E. The feeling of excitement and intensity conveyed by a particular type of music or performance.

F. The ability to create original and expressive music that showcases the artist's unique style and creativity.

G. Highly complex and intricate guitar playing, often featuring extended solos and technical flourishes.

H. Emotionally powerful and expressive vocal performances that showcase a singer's range and skill.

I. A dedicated and loyal fan or supporter of a particular type of music, band, or artist.

J. Upbeat and cheerful melodies that convey a sense of positivity and happiness.

UNIT 3: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 04 - Video, Mobile, PC Games

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|----------------------|-------|
| 1. Trash-talking | _____ |
| 2. Fast-paced action | _____ |
| 3. Strategy | _____ |
| 4. Outmaneuvering | _____ |
| 5. Bragging rights | _____ |
| 6. Elation | _____ |
| 7. Memories | _____ |
| 8. Cherish | _____ |
| 9. Grown up | _____ |
| 10. Moved on | _____ |

- A. The feeling of great happiness or excitement.
- B. The act of verbally insulting or provoking one's opponent in a competitive setting.
- C. The ability to make smart and effective decisions in order to achieve a desired outcome.
- D. The process of avoiding or getting around an opponent's moves in order to gain an advantage.
- E. The sense of pride or accomplishment that comes from winning a competition or achieving a goal.
- F. Strong recollections of past events or experiences, often associated with positive emotions.
- G. To value or appreciate something highly.
- H. To mature or reach a state of adulthood.
- I. To move on from something or let go of past attachments.
- J. Exciting and fast-moving events, often associated with sports or action-oriented games.

UNIT 3: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 05 - Childhood games

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|------------------|-------|
| 1. Hide and seek | _____ |
| 2. Tag | _____ |
| 3. Kickball | _____ |
| 4. Hiding spots | _____ |
| 5. Seeker | _____ |
| 6. Creative | _____ |
| 7. Giggling | _____ |
| 8. Flashlights | _____ |
| 9. Navigate | _____ |
| 10. Nostalgia | _____ |

A. To find one's way through a particular area or space, often using a map or other tools.

B. A feeling of affection or longing for something from the past.

C. A game in which one player chases and tries to touch another player, who then becomes "it."

D. A game in which players take turns kicking a ball and running around a set of bases.

E. A person who searches for or seeks out others in a game like hide and seek.

F. The act of coming up with new and interesting ideas or solutions.

G. The act of hiding in a particular location in order to avoid being found by other players.

H. The act of laughing softly and repeatedly, often associated with feeling amused or happy.

I. A small, handheld device used to produce a beam of light, often used in the dark to illuminate one's surroundings.

J. A classic childhood game in which one player counts while others hide, and then tries to find them.

UNIT 4: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 01 - Exercising

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|-------------------------|-------|
| 1. Endorphins | _____ |
| 2. Sedentary lifestyle | _____ |
| 3. Cardio | _____ |
| 4. Strength training | _____ |
| 5. Bodyweight exercises | _____ |
| 6. Kickboxing | _____ |
| 7. Fresh | _____ |
| 8. Routine | _____ |
| 9. Motivate | _____ |
| 10. In the zone | _____ |

A. A type of exercise that focuses on raising the heart rate and improving cardiovascular health.

B. The act of using one's own body weight to build strength and muscle.

C. The feeling of being completely focused and in the moment during a workout or other activity.

D. Chemicals released in the brain during exercise that can help reduce stress and improve mood.

E. A lifestyle that involves little physical activity, often associated with sitting for long periods of time.

F. A type of exercise that involves using weights or resistance to build strength and muscle.

G. A feeling of excitement or inspiration that encourages someone to take action.

H. A type of exercise that combines martial arts and boxing techniques.

I. A sense of newness or novelty in an exercise routine, often used to prevent boredom or burnout.

J. A set of regular habits or activities that one follows on a daily or weekly basis.

UNIT 4: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 02 - Nutrition

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|----------------------|-------|
| 1. Vicious cycle | _____ |
| 2. Eating habits | _____ |
| 3. Guilty | _____ |
| 4. Ashamed | _____ |
| 5. Swapping out | _____ |
| 6. Overwhelming | _____ |
| 7. Sluggish | _____ |
| 8. Fitting | _____ |
| 9. Protagonist | _____ |
| 10. Physical effects | _____ |

- A. The main character in a story or situation.
- B. The effects or changes that can be seen or felt on the body.
- C. The feeling of being exhausted or lacking energy.
- D. A pattern of events or behaviors that continue to worsen and repeat themselves.
- E. The act of replacing one thing with another.
- F. The way that someone consistently eats or approaches food.
- G. The feeling of having done something wrong or bad.
- H. The feeling of being incapable of dealing with or managing a situation.
- I. The feeling of having done something to embarrass oneself or feel guilty about.
- J. The way that clothing fits on the body.

UNIT 4: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 03 - Dealing with stress

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|----------------------|-------|
| 1. Coping mechanisms | _____ |
| 2. Overwhelmed | _____ |
| 3. Drowning | _____ |
| 4. Therapeutic | _____ |
| 5. Prioritize | _____ |
| 6. Self-care | _____ |
| 7. Mental break | _____ |
| 8. Desk job | _____ |
| 9. Support system | _____ |
| 10. Cope with stress | _____ |

- A. A job that primarily involves sitting at a desk or computer.
- B. The feeling of being unable to manage or handle a situation.
- C. Something that is intended to or used to provide healing or beneficial effects for physical or mental health.
- D. Activities or strategies used to manage stress and difficult situations.
- E. The feeling of being completely consumed or submerged in a stressful situation.
- F. The act of taking care of one's physical and emotional needs.
- G. A break from work or other stressful situations to rest and recharge.
- H. The act of organizing and managing tasks and responsibilities according to their level of importance.
- I. People or resources that offer emotional or practical support during stressful situations.
- J. The process of dealing with and managing stress in a healthy way.

UNIT 4: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 04 - Hospitals and illnesses

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|--------------------------|-------|
| 1. Ached | _____ |
| 2. Respiratory infection | _____ |
| 3. Antibiotics | _____ |
| 4. Fluids | _____ |
| 5. Grateful | _____ |
| 6. Medical help | _____ |
| 7. Care | _____ |
| 8. Serious | _____ |
| 9. Ignore | _____ |
| 10. Signs | _____ |

- A. Feeling thankful for something or someone.
- B. Liquids that can help you stay hydrated and flush out toxins.
- C. Assistance provided by a medical professional, such as a doctor or nurse.
- D. To take precautions and ensure that someone is safe and healthy.
- E. An illness that affects the lungs or airways, such as the flu or pneumonia.
- F. Medications that can help fight bacterial infections.
- G. A situation that is dangerous or potentially life-threatening.
- H. To pay no attention to something or someone, often to your own detriment.
- I. Indications that a person may be experiencing a certain condition or illness.
- J. To feel a continuous, dull pain in a part of your body.

UNIT 4: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 05 - Home remedies and treatments

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|--------------------------------|-------|
| 1. Miserable | _____ |
| 2. Soothed | _____ |
| 3. Nutrition | _____ |
| 4. Sinuses | _____ |
| 5. Infection | _____ |
| 6. Ritual | _____ |
| 7. Comforting | _____ |
| 8. Symptom | _____ |
| 9. Germs | _____ |
| 10. Coming down with something | _____ |

- A. To begin to experience the symptoms of an illness.
- B. Microscopic organisms that can cause disease.
- C. A physical or mental feature that indicates a particular condition or illness.
- D. Providing a feeling of calm or reassurance.
- E. A set of actions that are always performed in the same way.
- F. Air-filled spaces in the bones of the face that connect to the nose.
- G. The process of providing or obtaining the food necessary for health and growth.
- H. To be calm, relaxed, or comforted.
- I. Feeling unhappy, uncomfortable or sick.
- J. A disease caused by germs or bacteria.

UNIT 5: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 01 - Popular jobs and careers

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|-------------------------|-------|
| 1. Monotonous | _____ |
| 2. Impact | _____ |
| 3. Industry | _____ |
| 4. Evolving | _____ |
| 5. Creativity | _____ |
| 6. Technical skills | _____ |
| 7. Significant | _____ |
| 8. Tight deadlines | _____ |
| 9. Meaningful solutions | _____ |
| 10. High-quality work | _____ |

- A. The ability to use imagination and original ideas to create something.
- B. The ability to perform tasks related to a specific job or field.
- C. Having a great importance or consequence.
- D. Requiring completion in a very limited amount of time.
- E. The sector of the economy that involves the production and sale of goods or services.
- F. Requiring effort that does not offer variety, interest, or challenge.
- G. Changing or developing gradually over time.
- H. Work that meets a certain standard of excellence.
- I. Solving problems in a way that is worthwhile and significant.
- J. The effect or influence that something has on a situation or person.

UNIT 5: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 02 - Workplace culture and colleagues

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|----------------------|-------|
| 1. Work-life balance | _____ |
| 2. Well-being | _____ |
| 3. Perks | _____ |
| 4. Flexibility | _____ |
| 5. Personal growth | _____ |
| 6. Development | _____ |
| 7. Collaboration | _____ |
| 8. Empowered | _____ |
| 9. Innovative | _____ |
| 10. Solutions | _____ |

- A. The ability to work in different ways or at different times.
- B. The state of being happy, healthy, and successful.
- C. A special benefit or advantage offered to employees.
- D. The process of becoming better or more advanced.
- E. A mutually beneficial effort by a group of people to achieve a common goal.
- F. The ability to make decisions and take action with confidence.
- G. Original and creative in thinking.
- H. Work that provides a solution to a problem or challenge.
- I. The amount of time and energy spent on work compared to the amount spent on other activities.
- J. The process of improving or expanding one's knowledge and skills.

UNIT 5: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 03 - Interesting and dangerous jobs

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|-------------------------|-------|
| 1. Unpredictable | _____ |
| 2. Harsh weather | _____ |
| 3. Braving | _____ |
| 4. High winds | _____ |
| 5. Rough waves | _____ |
| 6. Icy temperatures | _____ |
| 7. Contend | _____ |
| 8. Crew members | _____ |
| 9. Camaraderie | _____ |
| 10. Thrill of the catch | _____ |

- A. The state of being uncertain or variable.
- B. Enduring or facing difficult or dangerous situations.
- C. A feeling of companionship or goodwill among a group of people.
- D. Members of a team or group working towards a common goal.
- E. The excitement and sense of accomplishment from successfully catching something.
- F. Weather conditions that are severe, uncomfortable, or dangerous.
- G. Dealing with or facing a challenge or difficulty.
- H. Air currents moving at a high speed.
- I. Large, turbulent waves that are difficult to navigate.
- J. Extremely cold temperatures.

UNIT 5: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 04 - Leadership in the workplace

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|--------------------|-------|
| 1. Competent | _____ |
| 2. Compassionate | _____ |
| 3. Admire | _____ |
| 4. Communicator | _____ |
| 5. Feedback | _____ |
| 6. Concerns | _____ |
| 7. Motivate | _____ |
| 8. Recognition | _____ |
| 9. Concise | _____ |
| 10. Rally together | _____ |

- A. To inspire or encourage someone to take action.
- B. The ability to communicate effectively and clearly.
- C. To acknowledge or appreciate someone for their efforts or achievements.
- D. To express worry or interest about something.
- E. To come together in a unified effort.
- F. To have a high regard or respect for someone.
- G. Skilled or capable of doing something effectively.
- H. To provide comments or suggestions to improve something.
- I. Showing kindness and empathy towards others.
- J. Brief and to the point.

UNIT 5: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 05 - Common problems in the workplace

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|--------------------|-------|
| 1. Complaints | _____ |
| 2. Conflicts | _____ |
| 3. Interrupting | _____ |
| 4. Job description | _____ |
| 5. Burnout | _____ |
| 6. Detrimental | _____ |
| 7. Comes up | _____ |
| 8. Disengagement | _____ |
| 9. Concerns | _____ |
| 10. Addressing | _____ |

- A. To express worry or interest about something.
- B. The negative impact that results from something.
- C. The duties and responsibilities associated with a particular job.
- D. A state of physical, emotional, and mental exhaustion.
- E. The act of stopping someone from speaking or doing something.
- F. To encounter or experience something, often repeatedly.
- G. The act of dealing with a problem or issue.
- H. The state of feeling disconnected or disinterested.
- I. A situation in which two or more parties have incompatible goals or interests.
- J. Expressions of dissatisfaction or criticism.

UNIT 6: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 01 - E-commerce

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|------------------------|-------|
| 1. Avid | _____ |
| 2. Ecommerce | _____ |
| 3. Unbeatable | _____ |
| 4. Outweighs | _____ |
| 5. Return policies | _____ |
| 6. Competitive pricing | _____ |
| 7. Convenience | _____ |
| 8. Selection | _____ |
| 9. Downsides | _____ |
| 10. Benefits | _____ |

- A. The positive aspects or advantages of something.
- B. The negative aspects or disadvantages of something.
- C. The ease or comfort of using something.
- D. The variety or range of choices available.
- E. A person who is enthusiastic or passionate about something.
- F. Online buying and selling of goods and services.
- G. To have greater importance or significance than something else.
- H. Policies that govern the process of returning purchased items.
- I. Pricing that is competitive with other sellers in the market.
- J. Impossible to beat or surpass.

UNIT 6: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 02 - Social media

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|--------------------------|-------|
| 1. Millennial | _____ |
| 2. Followers | _____ |
| 3. Visual platform | _____ |
| 4. Cyberbullying | _____ |
| 5. Mindful | _____ |
| 6. Positive way | _____ |
| 7. Influencers | _____ |
| 8. Creative | _____ |
| 9. Unique | _____ |
| 10. Mental health impact | _____ |

- A. The effects that something has on a person's mental well-being.
- B. A person born between the years of 1981 and 1996.
- C. The ability to think outside of the box and come up with new and original ideas.
- D. An individual or group that has the power to affect the opinions or behavior of others.
- E. The practice of being aware of and attentive to one's thoughts and feelings.
- F. An online environment in which individuals use electronic communication to harass, intimidate, or threaten others.
- G. A social media term used to describe someone who follows a particular account or user.
- H. A platform that relies on visual content to communicate and engage with users.
- I. Something that is distinct and unlike anything else.
- J. A way of doing something that is positive and beneficial.

UNIT 6: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 03 - Cyberbullying

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|-------------------------|-------|
| 1. Prevalent | _____ |
| 2. Insidious | _____ |
| 3. Code of conduct | _____ |
| 4. Guidance counselors | _____ |
| 5. Administrators | _____ |
| 6. Assemblies | _____ |
| 7. Workshops | _____ |
| 8. Collaborative effort | _____ |
| 9. Address | _____ |
| 10. Trusted adult | _____ |

A. A person who is responsible for supervising and managing a school or educational institution.

B. A set of rules and guidelines that outline the expected behavior of individuals in a particular setting.

C. A person who provides academic, personal, and social support to students in a school setting.

D. Something that is widespread or commonly found in a particular area or group.

E. A gathering of students or faculty members for a specific purpose, such as to provide information or discuss a topic.

F. A situation or behavior that is gradual, subtle, and often harmful or dangerous.

G. An individual who is relied upon to provide support, guidance, and protection to someone else.

H. A coordinated effort between multiple parties to achieve a common goal or objective.

I. To acknowledge and deal with a problem or issue.

J. An educational program or event designed to provide specific knowledge or skills to participants.

UNIT 6: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 04 - Fake news

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|----------------------------|-------|
| 1. Misinformation | _____ |
| 2. Confusion | _____ |
| 3. Real-world consequences | _____ |
| 4. Evidence | _____ |
| 5. National security | _____ |
| 6. Exploited workers | _____ |
| 7. Legitimate news sources | _____ |
| 8. Public opinion | _____ |
| 9. Combat | _____ |
| 10. Accurately informed | _____ |

- A. Information that is false or misleading.
- B. The effects or outcomes of something that are experienced or observed in the real world.
- C. The security and defense of a nation or country.
- D. Information or facts that support a claim or argument.
- E. People who are taken advantage of or treated unfairly in the workplace.
- F. The views, beliefs, or attitudes of the general public.
- G. A state of being uncertain or unclear about something.
- H. The act of actively working to prevent or fight against something.
- I. Information that is true and correct.
- J. The sources or outlets that are considered trustworthy and reliable for news and information.

UNIT 6: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 05 - Streaming services

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|----------------------|-------|
| 1. Enthusiast | _____ |
| 2. Indulge | _____ |
| 3. Binge-watch | _____ |
| 4. Go-to | _____ |
| 5. Unique content | _____ |
| 6. Advantages | _____ |
| 7. Downsides | _____ |
| 8. Addiction | _____ |
| 9. Subscription fees | _____ |
| 10. Revolutionized | _____ |

- A. An excessive dependence on something, often to the point of harm.
- B. A person who is highly interested or passionate about a particular topic or activity.
- C. The act of watching several episodes of a TV show in one sitting.
- D. The fees that are paid to access a product or service over a period of time.
- E. The positive aspects or benefits of something.
- F. The negative aspects or drawbacks of something.
- G. To allow oneself to enjoy or indulge in something pleasurable.
- H. Content that is unique or different from what is typically available.
- I. A reliable or dependable source or option.
- J. To completely change or transform something.

UNIT 7: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 01 - Popular sports

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|------------------|-------|
| 1. Appreciate | _____ |
| 2. Evident | _____ |
| 3. Accessibility | _____ |
| 4. Passionate | _____ |
| 5. Energy | _____ |
| 6. Excitement | _____ |
| 7. Global | _____ |
| 8. Attract | _____ |
| 9. Qualities | _____ |
| 10. Individual | _____ |

- A. The state of being easily reached or entered.
- B. Having a strong feeling of enthusiasm or excitement for something.
- C. The power or ability to do something.
- D. The state or quality of being clear or obvious.
- E. The feeling of being interested in and drawn to something.
- F. A feeling of great enthusiasm and eagerness.
- G. Relating to or involving the whole world.
- H. The characteristics or features that make a person or thing unique.
- I. To recognize the value or significance of something.
- J. Relating to a single person or thing, as opposed to a group.

UNIT 7: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 02 - Team sports vs Individual sports

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|---|-------|
| 1. Calmness | _____ |
| 2. Focus | _____ |
| 3. Chaos | _____ |
| 4. Green (referring to the golf course) | _____ |
| 5. Hole-in-one | _____ |
| 6. Championship | _____ |
| 7. Accountability | _____ |
| 8. Success | _____ |
| 9. Failure | _____ |
| 10. Mental fortitude | _____ |

- A. The ability to maintain composure and stay relaxed, especially under pressure.
- B. The state of being responsible for one's actions and decisions.
- C. The mental strength and resilience needed to persevere in challenging situations.
- D. A shot in golf where the ball is hit directly from the tee into the hole with one stroke.
- E. A golf tournament in which the winner is crowned the best player.
- F. The level of concentration and attention given to a task or activity.
- G. A state of confusion and disorder.
- H. The achievement of one's goals and objectives.
- I. A lack of success or failure to achieve a desired outcome.
- J. The area of a golf course covered in well-manicured grass and surrounding the hole.

UNIT 7: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 03 - Olympics

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|---------------------------|-------|
| 1. Grace | _____ |
| 2. Flawless | _____ |
| 3. All-around competition | _____ |
| 4. Unparalleled skills | _____ |
| 5. Dedication | _____ |
| 6. Hard work | _____ |
| 7. Mental toughness | _____ |
| 8. Resilience | _____ |
| 9. Overcome | _____ |
| 10. Courage | _____ |

- A. The ability to recover quickly from difficulties and setbacks.
- B. A competition in which athletes compete in multiple events to determine the overall winner.
- C. The quality of being graceful, elegant, or stylish in movement or appearance.
- D. The state of being able to handle difficult or challenging situations.
- E. The quality of having no mistakes, errors, or flaws.
- F. The ability to persist in one's efforts despite obstacles and setbacks.
- G. The level of effort and commitment required to achieve a goal or objective.
- H. To successfully deal with a difficult or challenging situation or obstacle.
- I. The quality of possessing extraordinary abilities or talents that set one apart from others.
- J. The ability to face danger, difficulty, uncertainty, or pain without being overcome by fear.

UNIT 7: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 04 - Youth sports

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|--------------------|-------|
| 1. Camaraderie | _____ |
| 2. Teamwork | _____ |
| 3. Challenge | _____ |
| 4. Improvement | _____ |
| 5. Competition | _____ |
| 6. Championship | _____ |
| 7. Pride | _____ |
| 8. Dedication | _____ |
| 9. Persistence | _____ |
| 10. Supportiveness | _____ |

- A. The feeling of satisfaction or pleasure derived from one's own achievements or those of someone with whom one is closely associated.
- B. The quality of being supportive or helpful to others.
- C. The quality of being dedicated or committed to a task or goal.
- D. The state of competing for a prize or reward, such as a trophy or title.
- E. The ability to persist in one's efforts despite obstacles and setbacks.
- F. A difficult task or problem that requires effort and skill to overcome.
- G. The state of working together as a group to achieve a common goal.
- H. The quality of being friendly and having a good rapport with others.
- I. The act of making something better or more advanced than before.
- J. A tournament or series of contests in which the winner is declared the best.

UNIT 7: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Sports 05 - Extreme sports

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|----------------------------------|-------|
| 1. Rush of adrenaline | _____ |
| 2. Pushing yourself to the limit | _____ |
| 3. Base jumping | _____ |
| 4. Achieving the impossible | _____ |
| 5. Capable of more than we think | _____ |
| 6. Set of dangers | _____ |
| 7. Take necessary precautions | _____ |
| 8. Follow protocols | _____ |
| 9. Perseverance | _____ |
| 10. Facing one's fears | _____ |

- A. The quality of continuing to do something despite difficulties, setbacks, or opposition.
- B. The state of experiencing a sudden burst of energy, excitement, or enthusiasm.
- C. The act of jumping from a high structure or object and using a parachute to slow one's descent.
- D. The act of achieving something that was previously thought to be impossible or unattainable.
- E. The ability to do more or achieve more than we initially believed was possible.
- F. A collection of hazards, risks, or threats that must be taken into account before taking action.
- G. The steps or procedures that must be followed to ensure safety, accuracy, or effectiveness.
- H. The act of putting measures in place to prevent or minimize potential harm or danger.
- I. The act of intentionally challenging oneself to the fullest extent possible.
- J. The act of confronting one's fears or anxieties in order to overcome them.

UNIT 8: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 01 - Investing

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|--------------------------|-------|
| 1. Diversification | _____ |
| 2. Portfolio | _____ |
| 3. Mutual funds | _____ |
| 4. 401(k) | _____ |
| 5. Economic developments | _____ |
| 6. Adjusting | _____ |
| 7. Nest egg | _____ |
| 8. Golden years | _____ |
| 9. Emotions | _____ |
| 10. Panic | _____ |

- A. A collection of financial assets such as stocks, bonds, and cash.
- B. A retirement savings plan offered by employers in the United States.
- C. The process of making small changes to a financial plan over time.
- D. The years after retirement, typically viewed as a time to enjoy leisure activities.
- E. An investment strategy that involves spreading money among different types of assets to reduce risk.
- F. An individual's savings set aside for future use, especially for retirement.
- G. Strong feelings such as happiness, sadness, or anger.
- H. Sudden and overwhelming fear or anxiety.
- I. Pooled money from many investors used to buy a diversified mix of stocks, bonds, and other assets.
- J. Changes in the economy that affect the way people live and work.

UNIT 8: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 02 - Passive income

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|-------------------------|-------|
| 1. Financial freedom | _____ |
| 2. Passive income | _____ |
| 3. Resignation letter | _____ |
| 4. Corporation | _____ |
| 5. Rental properties | _____ |
| 6. Analysis | _____ |
| 7. Landlord | _____ |
| 8. Legal aspects | _____ |
| 9. Pursuing hobbies | _____ |
| 10. Traditional 9-5 job | _____ |

- A. A letter used to formally notify an employer of an employee's intent to leave their job.
- B. A company or group of people authorized to act as a single entity.
- C. The process of examining something in detail in order to understand it better or make decisions.
- D. The legal responsibilities and obligations associated with a particular activity or role.
- E. The ability to live without having to work to meet one's basic needs and financial obligations.
- F. An individual who owns and manages a property that is rented to tenants.
- G. Income received on a regular basis, with little or no effort required to maintain it.
- H. Hobbies or interests pursued outside of work or other obligations.
- I. A traditional work schedule that typically runs from 9am to 5pm, Monday through Friday.
- J. Real estate properties that are leased or rented to tenants.

UNIT 8: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 03 - Budgeting and spending

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|----------------------|-------|
| 1. Budgeting | _____ |
| 2. Tracking spending | _____ |
| 3. Revelations | _____ |
| 4. Dining out | _____ |
| 5. Recurring fees | _____ |
| 6. Spreadsheet | _____ |
| 7. Potluck dinners | _____ |
| 8. Subscriptions | _____ |
| 9. Memberships | _____ |
| 10. Goal | _____ |

- A. A document or software program used to organize and analyze data, often used in financial planning.
- B. An organized plan for managing one's finances, including income and expenses.
- C. Shared meals where each guest brings a dish to contribute to the meal.
- D. Fees that are charged regularly, typically on a monthly or yearly basis.
- E. Discoveries or surprising facts that were previously unknown.
- F. Eating at restaurants or other food establishments outside of the home.
- G. Regular payments made to access a particular product or service.
- H. A plan or objective to work towards.
- I. Keeping track of where one's money is going in order to better manage finances.
- J. Paid access to a particular organization or group.

UNIT 8: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 04 - Retirement

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|------------------|-------|
| 1. Drastic | _____ |
| 2. Laid-back | _____ |
| 3. Chaos | _____ |
| 4. Diversity | _____ |
| 5. Array | _____ |
| 6. Socializing | _____ |
| 7. Pursue | _____ |
| 8. Grateful | _____ |
| 9. Opportunities | _____ |
| 10. Adjust | _____ |

A. A variety or selection of something.

B. Refers to differences among people, including race, ethnicity, gender, age, and culture.

C. Calm and relaxed, often used to describe a lifestyle or attitude.

D. Making significant changes in a short period of time.

E. The process of making changes to fit a particular situation or environment.

F. A state of confusion or disorder, often used to describe a situation or environment.

G. Actively engaging with others in a social setting.

H. Being thankful or appreciative of something, often used to describe an attitude or emotion.

I. The chance or possibility to do something, often used to describe potential career or personal choices.

J. The act of working towards a particular goal or objective.

UNIT 8: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 05 - Winning the lottery

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|--------------------------|-------|
| 1. Apprehension | _____ |
| 2. Drastic | _____ |
| 3. Burdened | _____ |
| 4. Peace of mind | _____ |
| 5. Newfound | _____ |
| 6. Diversified portfolio | _____ |
| 7. Financial future | _____ |
| 8. Life-changing event | _____ |
| 9. Joy | _____ |
| 10. Means | _____ |

- A. The resources or ability to do something.
- B. A significant event or occurrence that brings about major changes in one's life.
- C. Feeling weighed down or stressed by a particular situation or circumstance.
- D. A sense of security and comfort, often used to describe a feeling of relief or satisfaction.
- E. Recently discovered or acquired, often used to describe a new skill or opportunity.
- F. A variety of investments in different asset classes, used to minimize risk and maximize return.
- G. Plans and expectations for one's financial situation in the future.
- H. A mix of worry and fear about something that may happen in the future.
- I. Significant or extreme, often used to describe changes or actions.
- J. A feeling of happiness or contentment.

UNIT 9: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 01 - Traveling

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|----------------------|-------|
| 1. Iconic | _____ |
| 2. Day trip | _____ |
| 3. Landmark | _____ |
| 4. Invigorating | _____ |
| 5. Hiccups | _____ |
| 6. Adventure | _____ |
| 7. Cuisine | _____ |
| 8. Language barriers | _____ |
| 9. Breathtaking | _____ |
| 10. Ways of life | _____ |

A. A short excursion or outing to a nearby location or attraction, usually returning the same day.

B. A feature or structure that is recognized as historically significant or representative of a particular place or culture.

C. A variety of dishes and foods that are associated with a particular culture or region.

D. Impressive or awe-inspiring, often used to describe natural scenery or landmarks.

E. Obstacles or difficulties that arise unexpectedly and cause problems or delays.

F. A thrilling or exciting experience, often involving some level of risk or uncertainty.

G. The customs, traditions, and beliefs that shape the culture and identity of a particular group of people.

H. Communication challenges that arise when people who speak different languages interact.

I. Famous, well-known, or widely recognized, often used to describe a person or place.

J. Energizing or rejuvenating, often used to describe physical activities or experiences.

UNIT 9: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 02 - International festivals

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|--------------------|-------|
| 1. Studying abroad | _____ |
| 2. Festival | _____ |
| 3. International | _____ |
| 4. Lederhosen | _____ |
| 5. Dirndls | _____ |
| 6. Floats | _____ |
| 7. Marching bands | _____ |
| 8. Immersion | _____ |
| 9. Bratwurst | _____ |
| 10. Atmosphere | _____ |

A. Sausage that is commonly associated with German cuisine, often served at festivals and other events.

B. A type of leather shorts that are traditionally worn by men in Bavarian culture.

C. A type of traditional dress worn by women in Bavarian culture, consisting of a blouse, bodice, full skirt, and apron.

D. A cultural event or celebration that typically involves music, food, and other festivities.

E. Involvement or engagement in a particular environment or culture, often used to describe language learning or travel experiences.

F. A type of parade decoration or display, often featuring elaborate and colorful designs.

G. A group of musicians who perform while marching or walking in a procession.

H. The feeling or mood created by a particular setting or environment, often used to describe social events or gatherings.

I. Refers to the act of pursuing educational opportunities or programs in a foreign country.

J. Refers to events or activities that involve multiple countries or cultures.

UNIT 9: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 03 - International cuisine

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|--------------------------------|-------|
| 1. International food festival | _____ |
| 2. Ingredients | _____ |
| 3. Spices | _____ |
| 4. Thai chicken curry | _____ |
| 5. Indian samosa | _____ |
| 6. Korean barbecue | _____ |
| 7. Fermented bean dish | _____ |
| 8. Tres leches cake | _____ |
| 9. Socialize | _____ |
| 10. Love of food | _____ |

A. A popular dessert from Mexico, made with three types of milk and often topped with whipped cream or fruit.

B. An event or gathering where people come together to enjoy food and drinks and socialize with others.

C. A dish from Korea, consisting of marinated meat cooked over an open flame or grill.

D. An Indian appetizer or snack, typically filled with spiced vegetables or meat and fried or baked.

E. A savory dish from Thailand, made with a spicy curry sauce and chicken, served with rice or noodles.

F. A type of dish that uses various seasonings, such as herbs or spices, to add flavor to food.

G. A type of dish made from beans that have been fermented or pickled, often used in Asian cuisine.

H. The basic components of a recipe or dish, such as meat, vegetables, or grains.

I. Refers to the enjoyment or passion for food, cooking, or trying new dishes and cuisines.

J. A type of event or festival that celebrates different types of food and cooking styles from around the world.

UNIT 9: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 04 - Medical tourism

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|-------------------------------|-------|
| 1. Medical tourism | _____ |
| 2. Chronic pain | _____ |
| 3. Minimally invasive surgery | _____ |
| 4. Quality of care | _____ |
| 5. Professional and attentive | _____ |
| 6. Cultural immersion | _____ |
| 7. Practical solution | _____ |
| 8. Lack of access | _____ |
| 9. Modern and well-equipped | _____ |
| 10. Local culture | _____ |

A. Refers to a type of medical treatment that is performed with minimal damage to surrounding tissue, often resulting in shorter recovery times and less scarring.

B. The overall level of service, attention, and effectiveness provided by healthcare professionals and facilities.

C. A situation where someone is unable to obtain necessary healthcare services due to factors such as location, cost, or insurance coverage.

D. Refers to the process of experiencing and learning about the customs, traditions, and lifestyle of a particular community or region.

E. A type of travel that involves seeking medical treatment or procedures in a foreign country.

F. A persistent and often severe discomfort or ache in a particular area of the body, typically lasting for several months or longer.

G. Describes a setting or facility that is modern, up-to-date, and equipped with the latest technology and resources.

H. A solution or course of action that is practical or realistic given a particular set of circumstances.

I. The attitudes and behaviors expected in a particular social group or community, often involving traditions, values, and cultural norms.

J. Refers to healthcare professionals who are highly skilled, knowledgeable, and dedicated to their work.

UNIT 9: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 05 - Landmarks and historical sites

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|-----------------------|-------|
| 1. Landmark | _____ |
| 2. Historical site | _____ |
| 3. Awe-inspiring | _____ |
| 4. Fortifications | _____ |
| 5. Ingenuity | _____ |
| 6. Perseverance | _____ |
| 7. Sheer scale | _____ |
| 8. Breathtaking views | _____ |
| 9. National pride | _____ |
| 10. Cultural heritage | _____ |

A. The sense of respect and admiration that people feel for their country, its history, and its culture.

B. The ability to create or invent something new or innovative, often in response to a difficult or challenging situation.

C. A structure or series of structures built to defend a particular area or location.

D. A place or location that has significant cultural, historical, or symbolic meaning, often attracting large numbers of visitors or tourists.

E. Refers to the natural beauty or impressive scope of a particular view or landscape.

F. A feeling of profound wonder or amazement, often in response to something impressive or remarkable.

G. The act of persisting or persevering through difficult or challenging circumstances.

H. Refers to the size, magnitude, or extent of a particular object or structure.

I. Refers to the traditions, customs, beliefs, and artifacts that are passed down from generation to generation within a particular culture or society.

J. A particular object, structure, or location that is recognized as having historical, cultural, or symbolic significance.

UNIT 10: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 01 - Artificial intelligence

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|---------------------------------|-------|
| 1. Potential | _____ |
| 2. Application | _____ |
| 3. Healthcare | _____ |
| 4. Diagnoses | _____ |
| 5. Environmental sustainability | _____ |
| 6. Data analysis | _____ |
| 7. Natural disasters | _____ |
| 8. Inequalities | _____ |
| 9. Ethical considerations | _____ |
| 10. Exacerbate | _____ |

- A. The act of using something in a practical way or for a particular purpose.
- B. Refers to the potential for something to exist or happen in the future.
- C. Refers to the maintenance of environmental conditions and resources for future generations.
- D. Refers to situations where people are treated unfairly or have unequal access to resources or opportunities.
- E. Refers to situations where existing problems or challenges are made worse or more severe.
- F. Refers to the practice of analyzing large amounts of data in order to identify patterns, trends, or insights.
- G. Refers to the process of identifying and treating illnesses or medical conditions.
- H. Refers to the moral and ethical considerations that must be taken into account when developing or deploying technologies or policies.
- I. Refers to catastrophic events caused by natural phenomena, such as earthquakes, hurricanes, or floods.
- J. Refers to the process of identifying a particular condition or illness through medical examination and analysis.

UNIT 10: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 02 - Space exploration

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|---------------------------|-------|
| 1. Fascinating | _____ |
| 2. Gaze | _____ |
| 3. Insights | _____ |
| 4. Practical applications | _____ |
| 5. Astrobiology | _____ |
| 6. Space medicine | _____ |
| 7. Ingenuity | _____ |
| 8. Complexity | _____ |
| 9. Cosmos | _____ |
| 10. Ambition | _____ |

- A. The study of life in the universe beyond Earth.
- B. The quality of being intricate or complicated.
- C. The universe as a whole; the totality of all matter, energy, and space.
- D. The ability to come up with new and innovative ideas or solutions.
- E. The drive and determination to achieve one's goals.
- F. To look intently or fixedly, often with admiration or wonder.
- G. Useful and relevant to real-world situations or problems.
- H. Interesting or captivating.
- I. Medical research and practice in space or as related to space travel.
- J. New and valuable understandings or perspectives gained through analysis or investigation.

UNIT 10: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 03 - Alternative energy

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|-----------------------------|-------|
| 1. Environmental engineer | _____ |
| 2. Alternative energy | _____ |
| 3. Renewable sources | _____ |
| 4. Climate change | _____ |
| 5. Mitigate | _____ |
| 6. Fossil fuels | _____ |
| 7. Greenhouse gas emissions | _____ |
| 8. Innovative | _____ |
| 9. Practical | _____ |
| 10. Efficient | _____ |

- A. A type of energy that is not derived from fossil fuels.
- B. A person who designs and develops technologies to protect the environment.
- C. A process to lessen the negative impact of something.
- D. A term used to describe the increasing global temperature caused by human activity.
- E. A fuel that is formed from the remains of dead organisms over millions of years.
- F. Gases such as carbon dioxide that trap heat in the Earth's atmosphere.
- G. Able to create new and original ideas.
- H. Capable of being put to use in a practical way.
- I. Sources of energy that are replenished naturally, such as wind and solar power.
- J. Able to achieve maximum productivity with minimum wasted effort or expense.

UNIT 10: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 04 - Electric cars

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|---------------------------|-------|
| 1. Contemplating | _____ |
| 2. Environmental benefits | _____ |
| 3. Harmful pollutants | _____ |
| 4. Global warming | _____ |
| 5. Charging stations | _____ |
| 6. Affordability | _____ |
| 7. Range | _____ |
| 8. Convenience | _____ |
| 9. Sustainability | _____ |
| 10. Priorities | _____ |

- A. The quality of being easy to use, do, or understand.
- B. The gradual increase in the average temperature of the Earth's atmosphere.
- C. The ability to meet the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs.
- D. Locations where electric vehicles can be charged.
- E. The positive effects that a product or service has on the environment.
- F. The ability of a vehicle to travel a certain distance on a single charge or tank of fuel.
- G. Substances that are released into the air, water, or soil that can cause harm to living things.
- H. Things that are considered to be more important than others.
- I. The act of thinking deeply about something.
- J. The amount of money that is required or available for a particular purpose.

UNIT 10: VOCABULARY AND EXPRESSIONS:

Story 05 - Virtual reality

Match the terms with the definitions:

- | | |
|--------------------|-------|
| 1. Skeptical | _____ |
| 2. Immersive | _____ |
| 3. Simulations | _____ |
| 4. Motion sickness | _____ |
| 5. Addiction | _____ |
| 6. Prohibitive | _____ |
| 7. Ethics | _____ |
| 8. Propaganda | _____ |
| 9. Manipulate | _____ |
| 10. Downsides | _____ |

- A. The state of being physically or mentally dependent on something
- B. Information that is used to promote or publicize a particular political cause or point of view
- C. To control or influence something or someone to one's advantage, often in a dishonest way
- D. Negative aspects or disadvantages of something
- E. Doubtful or disbelieving
- F. Involving complete attention or engagement
- G. Representations of real-world situations or processes
- H. Nausea caused by motion or movement
- I. Serving to prohibit or prevent
- J. Moral principles that govern behavior

Vocabulary and Expression Practice Answer Key

UNIT 1: STORY 01

1. E
2. G
3. F
4. I
5. J
6. B
7. C
8. D
9. A
10. H

UNIT 2: STORY 01

1. D
2. G
3. H
4. F
5. J
6. B
7. A
8. I
9. E
10. C

UNIT 3: STORY 01

1. J
2. E
3. F
4. G
5. H
6. I
7. C
8. A
9. D
10. B

UNIT 1: STORY 02

1. A
2. B
3. I
4. E
5. D
6. F
7. G
8. H
9. C
10. J

UNIT 2: STORY 02

:

1. E
2. F
3. G
4. H
5. B
6. I
7. J
8. C
9. D
10. A

UNIT 3: STORY 02

1. G
2. D
3. H
4. B
5. A
6. E
7. F
8. C
9. I
10. J

UNIT 1: STORY 03

1. A
2. E
3. G
4. J
5. I
6. F
7. B
8. H
9. C
10. D

UNIT 2: STORY 03

1. J
2. C
3. A
4. B
5. E
6. F
7. I
8. G
9. H
10. D

UNIT 3: STORY 03

1. I
2. A
3. D
4. J
5. E
6. C
7. F
8. G
9. H
10. B

UNIT 1: STORY 04

1. F
2. A
3. H
4. I
5. D
6. J
7. G
8. E
9. B
10. C

UNIT 2: STORY 04

1. B
2. C
3. H
4. G
5. I
6. A
7. J
8. D
9. E
10. F

UNIT 3: STORY 04

1. B
2. J
3. C
4. D
5. E
6. A
7. F
8. G
9. H
10. I

UNIT 1: STORY 05

1. G
2. J
3. C
4. B
5. I
6. D
7. A
8. H
9. E
10. F

UNIT 2: STORY 05

1. A
2. B
3. C
4. J
5. D
6. E
7. F
8. G
9. H
10. I

UNIT 3: STORY 05

1. J
2. C
3. D
4. G
5. E
6. F
7. H
8. I
9. A
10. B

UNIT 4: STORY 01

1. D
2. E
3. A
4. F
5. B
6. H
7. I
8. J
9. G
10. C

UNIT 4: STORY 02

1. D
2. F
3. G
4. I
5. E
6. H
7. C
8. J
9. A
10. B

UNIT 4: STORY 03

1. D
2. B
3. E
4. C
5. H
6. F
7. G
8. A
9. I
10. J

UNIT 4: STORY 04

1. J
2. E
3. F
4. B
5. A
6. C
7. D
8. G
9. H
10. I

UNIT 4: STORY 05

1. I
2. H
3. G
4. F
5. J
6. E
7. D
8. C
9. B
10. A

UNIT 5: STORY 01

1. F
2. J
3. E
4. G
5. A
6. B
7. C
8. D
9. I
10. H

UNIT 5: STORY 02

1. I
2. B
3. C
4. A
5. J
6. D
7. E
8. F
9. G
10. H

UNIT 5: STORY 03

1. A
2. F
3. B
4. H
5. I
6. J
7. G
8. D
9. C
10. E

UNIT 5: STORY 04

1. G
2. I
3. F
4. B
5. H
6. D
7. A
8. C
9. J
10. E

UNIT 5: STORY 05

1. J
2. I
3. E
4. C
5. D
6. B
7. F
8. H
9. A
10. G

UNIT 6: STORY 01

1. E
2. F
3. J
4. G
5. H
6. I
7. C
8. D
9. B
10. A

UNIT 6: STORY 02

1. B
2. G
3. H
4. F
5. E
6. J
7. D
8. C
9. I
10. A

UNIT 6: STORY 03

1. D
2. F
3. B
4. C
5. A
6. E
7. J
8. H
9. I
10. G

UNIT 6: STORY 04

1. A
2. G
3. B
4. D
5. C
6. E
7. J
8. F
9. H
10. I

UNIT 6: STORY 05

1. B
2. G
3. C
4. I
5. H
6. E
7. F
8. A
9. D
10. J

UNIT 7: STORY 01

1. I
2. D
3. A
4. B
5. C
6. F
7. G
8. E
9. H
10. J

UNIT 7: STORY 02

1. A
2. F
3. G
4. J
5. D
6. E
7. B
8. H
9. I
10. C

UNIT 7: STORY 03

1. C
2. E
3. B
4. I
5. G
6. F
7. D
8. A
9. H
10. J

UNIT 7: STORY 04

1. H
2. G
3. F
4. I
5. D
6. J
7. A
8. C
9. E
10. B

UNIT 7: STORY 05

1. B
2. I
3. C
4. D
5. E
6. F
7. H
8. G
9. A
10. J

UNIT 8: STORY 01

1. E
2. A
3. I
4. B
5. J
6. C
7. F
8. D
9. G
10. H

UNIT 8: STORY 02

1. E
2. G
3. A
4. B
5. J
6. C
7. F
8. D
9. H
10. I

UNIT 8: STORY 03

1. B
2. I
3. E
4. F
5. D
6. A
7. C
8. G
9. J
10. H

UNIT 8: STORY 04

1. D
2. C
3. F
4. B
5. A
6. G
7. J
8. H
9. I
10. E

UNIT 8: STORY 05

1. H
2. I
3. C
4. D
5. E
6. F
7. G
8. B
9. J
10. A

UNIT 9: STORY 01

1. I
2. A
3. B
4. J
5. E
6. F
7. C
8. H
9. D
10. G

UNIT 9: STORY 02

1. I
2. D
3. J
4. B
5. C
6. F
7. G
8. E
9. A
10. H

UNIT 9: STORY 03

1. J
2. H
3. F
4. E
5. D
6. C
7. G
8. A
9. B
10. I

UNIT 9: STORY 04

1. E
2. F
3. A
4. B
5. J
6. D
7. H
8. C
9. G
10. I

UNIT 9: STORY 05

1. J
2. D
3. F
4. C
5. B
6. G
7. H
8. E
9. A
10. I

UNIT 10: STORY 01

1. B
2. A
3. G
4. J
5. C
6. F
7. I
8. D
9. H
10. E

UNIT 10: STORY 02

1. H
2. F
3. J
4. G
5. A
6. I
7. D
8. B
9. C
10. E

UNIT 10: STORY 03

1. B
2. A
3. I
4. D
5. C
6. E
7. F
8. G
9. H
10. J

UNIT 10: STORY 04

1. I
2. E
3. G
4. B
5. D
6. J
7. F
8. A
9. C
10. H

UNIT 10: STORY 05

1. E
2. F
3. G
4. H
5. A
6. I
7. J
8. B
9. C
10. D

CONVERSATION STARTER

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